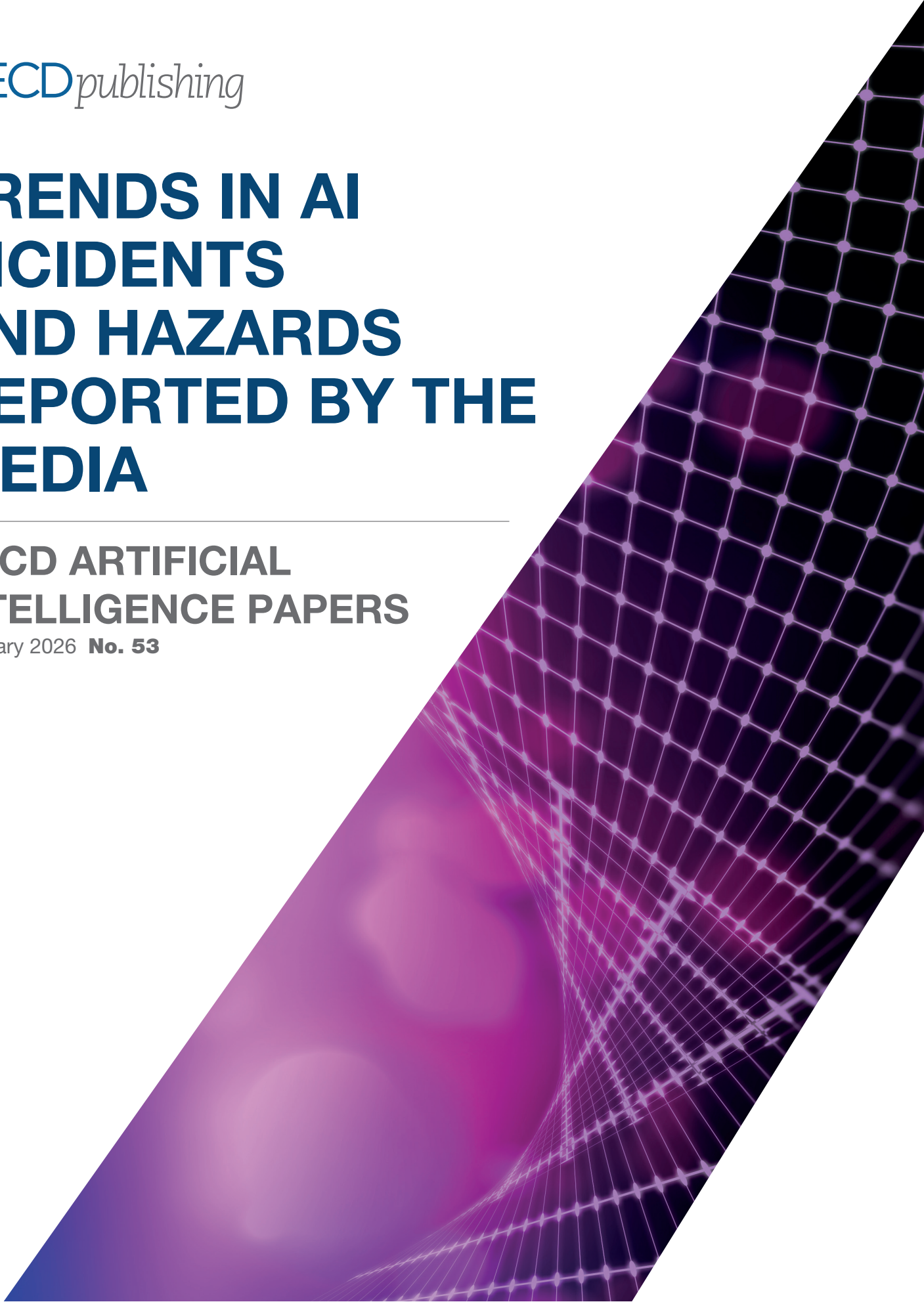
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TRENDS IN AI INCIDENTS AND HAZARDS REPORTED BY THE MEDIA

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Trends in AI incidents and hazards reported by the media



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Abstract

As AI adoption accelerates, understanding how risks emerge and evolve is critical. Media reports of AI incidents and hazards provide a real-time window into the types, frequency, and impact of AI-related risks and harms – and play a powerful role in shaping public discourse and policy agendas. This paper analyses live data from the OECD.AI Incidents and Hazards Monitor (AIM), classifying media reports into 14 themes, including synthetic media, child safety, cyberattacks, privacy, and health. It identifies three distinct patterns of media coverage – increasing, intermittent, and declining – and traces how media attention shifts across themes over time.

Résumé

À mesure que l'adoption et l'utilisation des systèmes d'IA s'accélère, il est essentiel de comprendre comment les risques associés apparaissent et évoluent. Les reportages médiatiques sur les incidents et dangers liés à l'IA offrent un aperçu en temps réels sur la nature, la fréquence et l'impact des risques liés à l'IA, et jouent un rôle important dans la formation du débat public et des programmes politiques. Ce rapport analyse les données en temps réels du *OECD.AI Incidents and Hazards Monitor* (AIM), en classant les reportages médiatiques en 14 groupes thématiques, notamment les médias synthétiques, la sécurité des enfants, les cyberattaques, la protection de la vie privée et la santé. Il met en évidence trois types de tendance distinctes de couverture médiatiques – croissante, intermittente et décroissante – et retrace l'évolution de l'attention médiatique portée au fil du temps selon les thèmes.

Acknowledgements

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This working paper describes preliminary results and research in progress and is published to stimulate discussion on trends in media-reported AI incidents and hazards. Luis Aranda, Bénédicte Rispal, and Karine Perset, from the OECD Artificial Intelligence and Emerging Digital Technologies Division (AIEDT) led the paper development and drafting.

Strategic direction was provided by Karine Perset (Acting Head of AIEDT); Audrey Plonk (Deputy Director) and Jerry Sheehan (Director) of the OECD Directorate for Science, Technology and Innovation (STI); and Gallia Daor (Senior Policy Advisor, STI).

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Table of contents

Abstract 3

Résumé 4

Acknowledgements 5

Executive summary 8

1 Introduction 10

2 Identifying key themes in media-reported AI incidents and hazards 13

3 Increasing coverage 16

4 Intermittent coverage 21

5 Decreasing coverage 28

6 Conclusion and next steps 34

Annex A. Methodological note 35

Annex B. Similarity between themes 39

References 41

FIGURES

Figure 1.1. Media reports of AI incidents and hazards have increased over time, but are losing share relative to all AI-related news 11

Figure 2.1. Distribution of media-reported AI incidents and hazards by theme over time 14

Figure 3.1. Media-reported AI incidents and hazards showing increasing shares of media coverage include synthetic media and child safety risks, cyberattacks and fraud, and labour market disruptions 16

Figure 3.2. Reports of synthetic media risks have more than doubled since 2022, now accounting for over 14% of all recorded incidents and hazards in AIM 17

Figure 3.3. The share of media reports linked to child safety doubled between 2022 and 2025 but peaked in late 2023 and early 2024 18

Figure 3.4. The share of media reports related to cyberattacks and fraud nearly tripled since 2022 19

Figure 3.5. Media-reported labour market disruptions remain a small but growing share of the total 20

Figure 4.1. Intermittent coverage is observed for AI-enabled warfare, LLMs, election interference and geopolitics, intellectual property, and long-term AI risks 21
Figure 4.2. After rising throughout 2024, media reports of incidents and hazards related to election interference and geopolitical issues peaked following DeepSeek deployment in February 2025 22
Figure 4.3. Following a steep decline, reports of warfare-related incidents and hazards are climbing again 23
Figure 4.4. Coverage of media reports related to LLM risks surged eightfold months after ChatGPT's release 24
Figure 4.5. Consistent media coverage of intellectual property incidents and hazards, with periodic surges 26
Figure 4.6. Spike in long-term risk reports reflects high-profile warnings and calls for regulation 27
Figure 5.1. Decreasing share of media coverage has been observed for incidents and hazards related to autonomous vehicles, biometric data, health, online platforms, and privacy 28
Figure 5.2. Coverage of incidents and hazards related to autonomous vehicles halved from 2022 29
Figure 5.3. Media reports of AI privacy violations dropped sharply in 2022 and have stabilised at around 8% 30
Figure 5.4. Media coverage of biometric data incidents and hazards has more than halved since 2022 31
Figure 5.5. Media coverage of incidents and hazards related to online platforms has dropped by about 50% since 2022 32
Figure 5.6. Media coverage of health AI incidents and hazards has decreased to about 3% of the total 33

Figure A.1. On average, media-reported AI incidents and hazards linked to environmental risks represented 0.6% of all reports 37
Figure A.2. Media reporting of AI incidents and hazards is highly correlated 38
Figure B.1. Semantic similarity matrix of the 14 themes 39

TABLES

Table 2.1. Key thematic clusters of media-reported AI incidents and hazards 13

Table A.1. Top keywords by theme 36
Table B.1. Average similarity score per theme 40

BOXES

Box 1.1. Definitions of AI incidents and hazards 10
Box 4.1. Notable launches of LLMs and LLM-powered tools in late 2022 and early 2023 25

Executive summary

Recent AI developments and adoption have been accompanied by increased attention to associated risks, highlighting the need to identify and respond to these challenges. These risks may correspond to *potential* harms ("hazards") or result in *actual* harm ("incidents"). Effective mechanisms for monitoring, reporting, and response are essential to understand, prevent, and mitigate these risks, as well as remedy incidents. In early 2025, the members of the Global Partnership on AI (GPAI) approved a common framework for reporting AI incidents, designed as an international data-sharing template for public and private organisations across jurisdictions and sectors (OECD, 2025[1]). This is especially crucial as some jurisdictions – including the EU through its AI Act – introduce reporting for AI incidents.

Data on AI incidents and hazards is critical for AI developers, deployers, and users to support their risk management efforts. They also help policymakers, researchers, and the public understand which risks are materialising, which are being addressed, how frequently they occur, and how severe their impacts are.

At present, there are few public and comparable sources of information on AI incidents and hazards. While major AI companies often track and sometimes share such information, much of it remains confidential (OECD, 2025[2]). Proxy indicators – such as court rulings on AI-related cases or media reports – can offer partial insights into where and what types of incidents are occurring.

This report analyses trends based on publicly available media articles. The findings reflect media and public interest rather than comprehensive or systematic tracking of AI incidents and hazards. Importantly, media reports capture only what journalists are aware of and deemed newsworthy. Other types of AI incidents, such as those resolved directly by developers or providers before reaching public attention, are therefore not captured in this analysis.

Media reports serve as a key channel through which AI incidents become visible to policymakers and the public, shaping awareness, public discourse, and policy agendas. Conversely, reliance on media sources may introduce errors of inclusion, as some reported incidents may be mischaracterised, exaggerated, or inaccurately attributed to AI due to limited background or technical understanding.

While the total number of AI incidents and hazards reported in public media surged between 2022 and 2025, their share relative to overall AI-related media articles slightly declined. The OECD.AI Incidents and Hazards Monitor (AIM) tracks these media-reported AI incidents and hazards in real-time and leverages the OECD common reporting framework to categorise them consistently.

Using machine learning techniques and keyword analysis, this report classifies media-reported AI incidents and hazards into the following 14 themes: risks linked to synthetic media; AI-enabled warfare; cyberattacks and fraud; risks related to online platforms, such as inappropriate recommendations; privacy violations; risks linked specifically to biometric data; risks linked to autonomous vehicles; issues specific to large language models (LLMs) such as hallucinations; election interference and other geopolitical issues; labour market disruptions; child safety; health issues; risks of intellectual property infringement; and other long-term risks. While some themes may be closely related, each highlights a distinct and important category of AI risks and harms. Each media-reported incident or hazard was assigned to the single most relevant theme based on the available information, enabling analytical clarity and preventing double counting.

Analysis across the 14 themes reveals three distinct trends in the share of media coverage:

- Themes attracting an increasing share of media coverage include AI incidents and hazards linked to synthetic media, child safety, and cyberattacks and fraud, which have more than doubled since 2022. Labour market disruptions remain relatively low in volume but are increasing steadily.
- Some themes exhibit intermittent, event-driven media coverage. Reported AI incidents and hazards linked to election interference and geopolitical issues; risks specific to large language models; and long-term risks show clear spikes in response to major events or developments. AI-enabled warfare risks, after declining, are again on the rise. Intellectual property risks remain stable but with periodic surges in coverage.
- Decreasing share of media coverage over time can be seen for reported AI incidents and hazards involving autonomous vehicles, privacy, biometric data, online platforms, and health. Nonetheless, monitoring these types of risks remains critical given their impacts on economies and societies.

1 Introduction

Artificial intelligence (AI) technologies have seen rapid adoption over recent years. Alongside this adoption, AI risks have started to materialise.

In response, various stakeholders, jurisdictions have emphasised the importance of reporting, monitoring and responding to AI incidents. In this context, the informal OECD.AI expert group on AI incidents, set up in January 2023, has informed the development of a common understanding of AI incidents and hazards. The expert group worked on two workstreams. The first workstream focused on defining AI incidents and related terminology and building a common framework to report them. The second workstream sought both to test the framework with actual examples and begin to build an evidence base to help understand trends in actual and potential AI risks.

The OECD definitions of an AI incident, AI hazard, and related terminology provide a shared understanding of these AI-related risks (OECD, 2024[3]). A common set of definitions supports consistent identification and measurement of AI incidents and hazards based on their severity, across borders and sectors (Box 1.1).

Box 1.1. Definitions of AI incidents and hazards

An **AI incident** is an event, circumstance or series of events where the development, use or malfunction of one or more AI systems directly or indirectly leads to any of the following harms:
(a) injury or harm to the health of a person or groups of people;
(b) disruption of the management and operation of critical infrastructure;
(c) violations of human rights or a breach of obligations under the applicable law intended to protect fundamental, labour and intellectual property rights;
(d) harm to property, communities or the environment.

An **AI hazard** is an event, circumstance or series of events where the development, use or malfunction of one or more AI systems could plausibly lead to an AI incident, i.e., any of the following harms:
(a) injury or harm to the health of a person or groups of people;
(b) disruption of the management and operation of critical infrastructure;
(c) violations to human rights or a breach of obligations under applicable law intended to protect fundamental labour and intellectual property rights;
(d) harm to property, communities or the environment.

Source: OECD (2024[3]).

The *OECD common reporting framework for AI incidents*, published in February 2025, supports a consistent approach to tracking AI incidents (OECD, 2025[1]). A shared framework helps stakeholders – including policymakers, developers, deployers and users – report incidents in a standardised manner to help understand the evolution and impacts of AI risks and harms. The framework enables the collection of information related to the socio-economic context of the AI incident, the associated AI model, and additional details such as the model's inputs, outputs, and relevant OECD AI Principles (OECD.AI, 2025[4]).

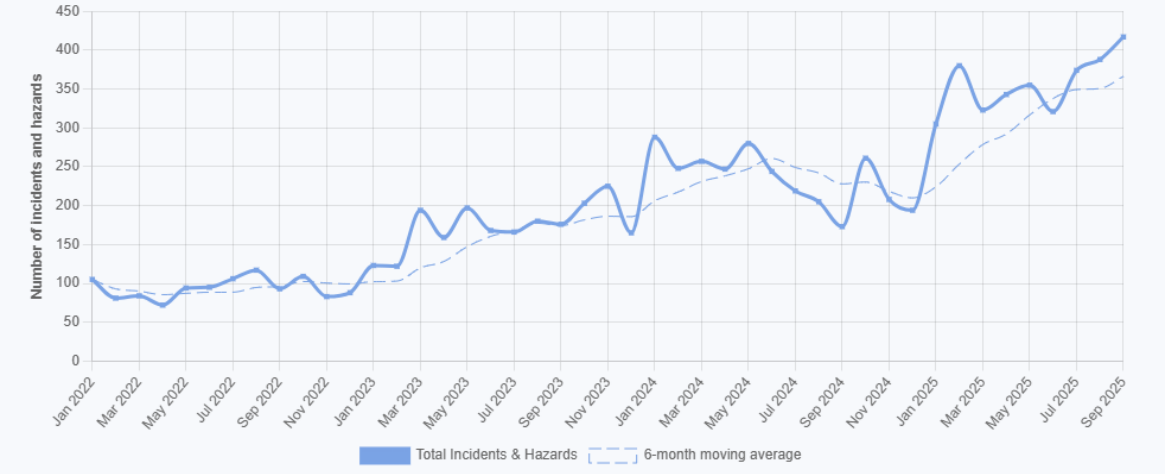
Building on this, the OECD.AI Incidents and Hazards Monitor (AIM) tracks real-time AI incidents and hazards as reported in the media (OECD.AI, 2025[5]). Currently the data rely on reports from the top 50% of media outlets, based on the Alexa traffic rankings (OECD.AI, 2025[6]). These reports are aggregated by Event Registry, a news intelligence platform which monitors over 150 000 news articles daily. Over time, AIM data will help identify patterns in media coverage and can provide insights into the nature and impact of risks and harms associated with AI technologies.

While AIM currently relies exclusively on media reporting, these sources provide a valuable and informative starting point. Media reports serve as a key channel through which AI incidents become visible to policymakers and the public, shaping awareness, public discourse, and policy agendas. As such, they offer important insights into the types of AI-related issues that attract attention, prompt concern, and drive regulatory and institutional responses. Future developments, such as incorporating case law data, academic literature, and open submissions, could expand the AIM's coverage and improve understanding of AI risks across the globe. Reports emerging from the G7 Hiroshima AI Process could further complement this work by providing concrete examples of how AI incidents are identified, assessed, and managed under different risk management frameworks (OECD.AI, 2025[7]).

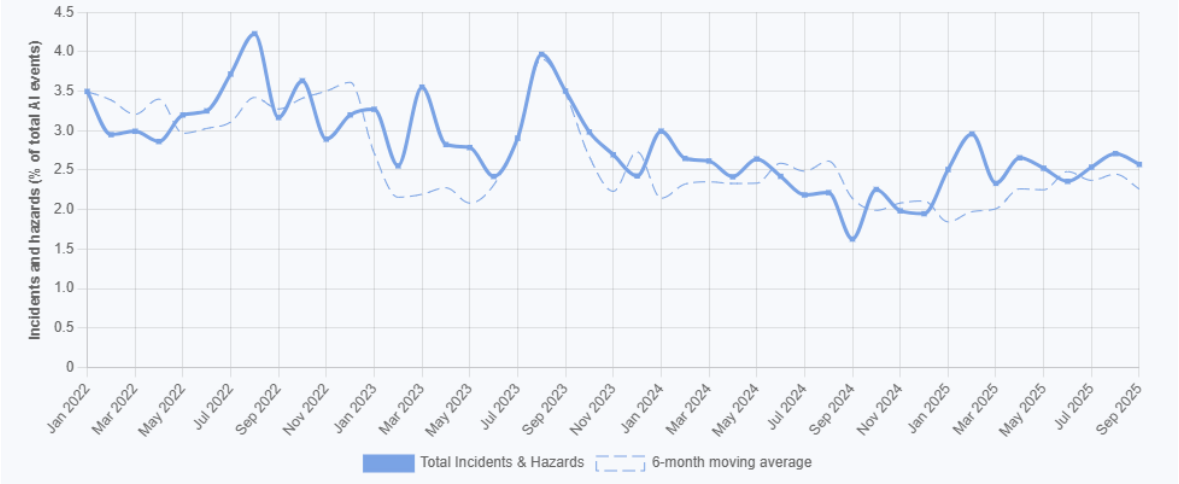
Between 2022 and 2025, the number of AI incidents and hazards reported by the media rose steadily, from 92 to 324 per month on average (Figure 1.1, Panel A). However, their share relative to total AI news declined, from 3.2% in 2022 to around 2.5% in 2025 (Figure 1.1, Panel B).

Figure 1.1. Media reports of AI incidents and hazards have increased over time, but are losing share relative to all AI-related news

Panel A. Evolution of media-reported AI incidents and hazards over time, absolute number



Panel B. Evolution of AI incidents and hazards over time, as share of total AI-related media reports



Note: An AI incident or hazard can be reported by one or more news articles covering the same event. Please see the methodological note for more information.
Source: OECD.AI (2025[5])

2 Identifying key themes in media-reported AI incidents and hazards

A thematic analysis of media-reported AI incidents and hazards between January 2022 to September 2025 resulted in the clustering of the data into 14 categories (Table 2.1). These categories are developed from machine learning analysis and keyword analysis. While certain thematic clusters inevitably intersect – for instance, some incidents related to *child safety* may involve the use of deepfakes, which could also be captured under *synthetic media* – the 14 themes capture distinct and policy-relevant areas of AI-related risks and harms and warrant separate attention despite potential overlaps.

To maintain analytical clarity and avoid double counting, each media-reported incident or hazard is assigned to the single most relevant theme based on the available information. This approach ensures conceptual coherence and enables comparability across themes. For example, incidents involving synthetic media used to generate child sexual abuse material are relevant to both *synthetic media* and *child safety*, but are assigned only to the most relevant cluster. Further methodological details are available in Annexes A and B. As new types of media-reported AI incidents and hazards emerge, these clusters may evolve or expand, reflecting ongoing developments in AI.

Table 2.1. Key thematic clusters of media-reported AI incidents and hazards

Theme name	Theme description
Synthetic media	Synthetic media generation (video, image, voice) resulting in false and misleading information
AI-enabled warfare	Military use of AI systems (e.g., AI-enabled drones)
Cyberattacks and fraud	AI for financial manipulation, scams, or exploiting legal gaps
Online platforms	AI-driven content recommendations and curation affecting user safety, exposure, or well-being
Privacy	Invasion of user privacy through AI-enhanced tracking, surveillance, or unauthorised data collection
Biometric data	Collection, misuse or leakage of biometric data, including facial recognition
Autonomous vehicles	Malfunctioning or unsafe autonomous vehicles
LLMs	Misuse, malfunction or failure of general-purpose AI tools (e.g., LLM-powered chatbots)
Election interference and geopolitics	AI's impact on democracy, national security, and geopolitical stability
Labour market	Impact of AI on jobs and the future of work
Child safety	AI-related risks and harms to children safety and wellbeing, including child sexual abuse material (CSAM)
Health	AI-related physical and mental health risks and harms
Intellectual property	Impacts of AI on intellectual property rights, including copyright
Long-term risks	Speculative future AI impacts on individuals and society

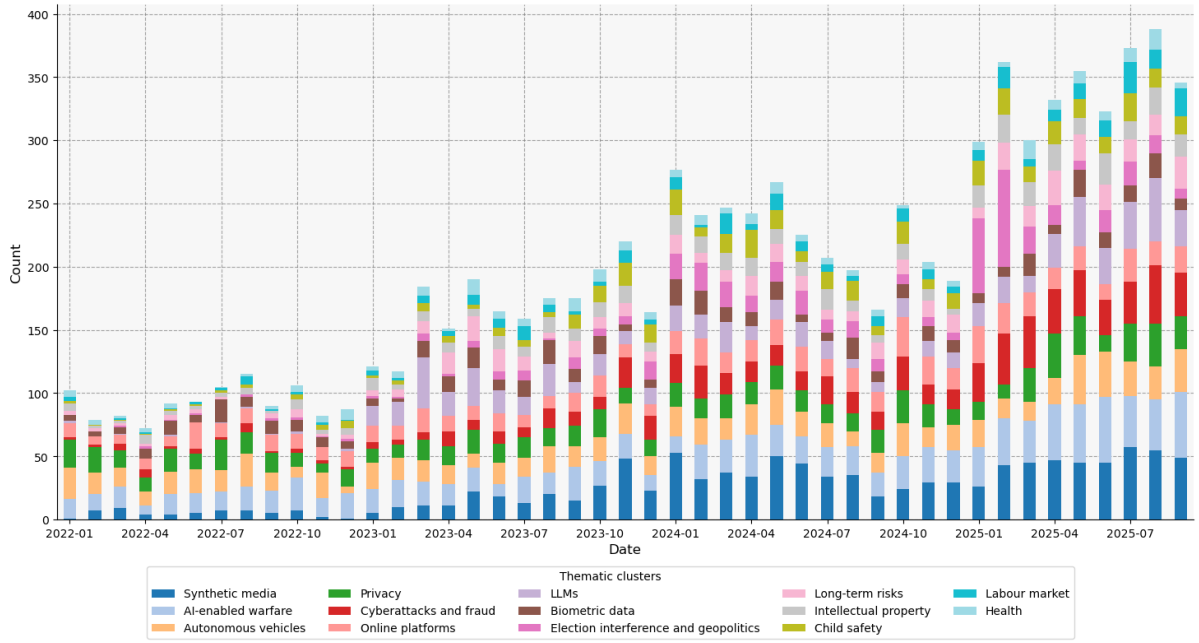
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025.

The number and share of media-reported AI incidents and hazards vary considerably across themes (Figure 2.1). On average, from 2022 until September 2025, *synthetic media* reports accounted for the

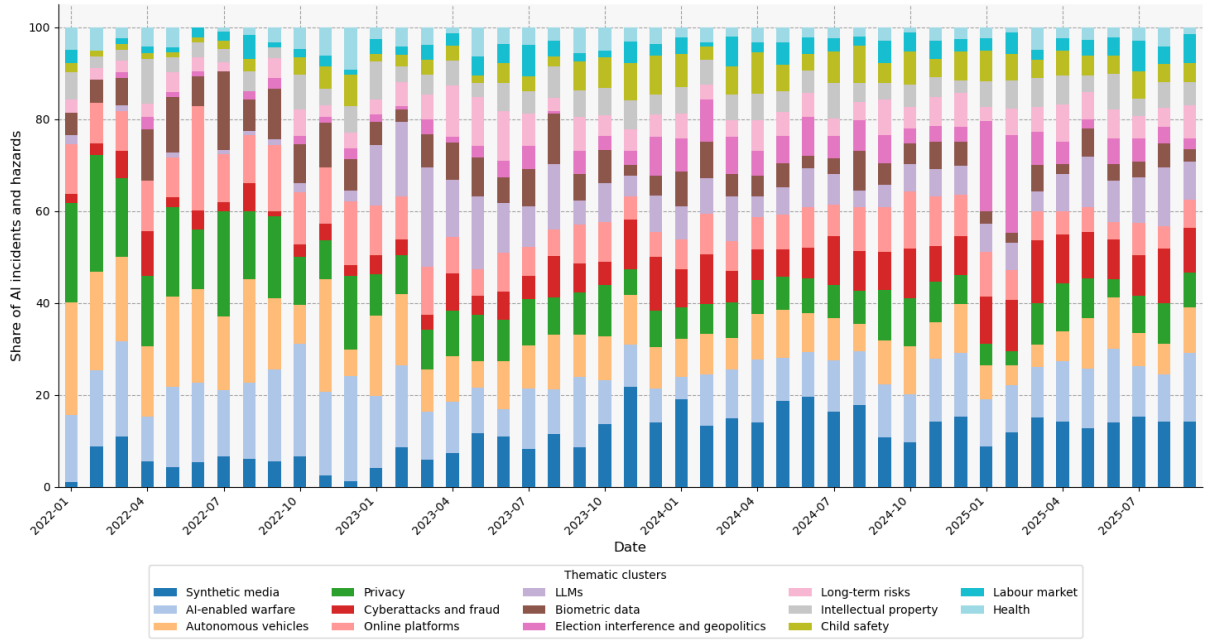
largest share at 12.5% of the total, followed by *AI-enabled warfare* (12.2%), *autonomous vehicle* risks (10%), and *privacy* violations (8.9%). In contrast, themes like *health* risks and *labour market* disruptions accounted for smaller shares, at 3.1% and 3.5% respectively.

Figure 2.1. Distribution of media-reported AI incidents and hazards by theme over time

Panel A. Number of media-reported AI incidents and hazards over time, by theme



Panel B. AI incidents and hazards by theme, as share of all media-reported AI incidents and hazards over time



Note: To avoid double-counting, each AI incident or hazard reported in the media was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025.

Based on these 14 thematic clusters, **three distinct trends** were identified according to the share of media-reported AI incidents and hazards relative to total AI news:

- Themes attracting an **increasing share of media coverage** include AI incidents and hazards linked to synthetic media, child safety, and cyberattacks and fraud that have more than doubled since 2022. Labour market disruptions remain relatively low in volume but are increasing steadily.
- Some themes exhibit **intermittent, event-driven media coverage**. Reported AI incidents linked to election interference and geopolitical issues; risks specific to large language models; and long-term risks show clear spikes in response to major events or developments. AI-enabled warfare risks, after declining, are again on the rise. Intellectual property risks remain stable but with periodic surges in coverage.
- **Decreasing shares of media coverage** over time can be seen for reported incidents and hazards involving autonomous vehicles, privacy, biometric data, online platforms, and health. Nonetheless, monitoring these remains critical given their impacts on economies and societies.

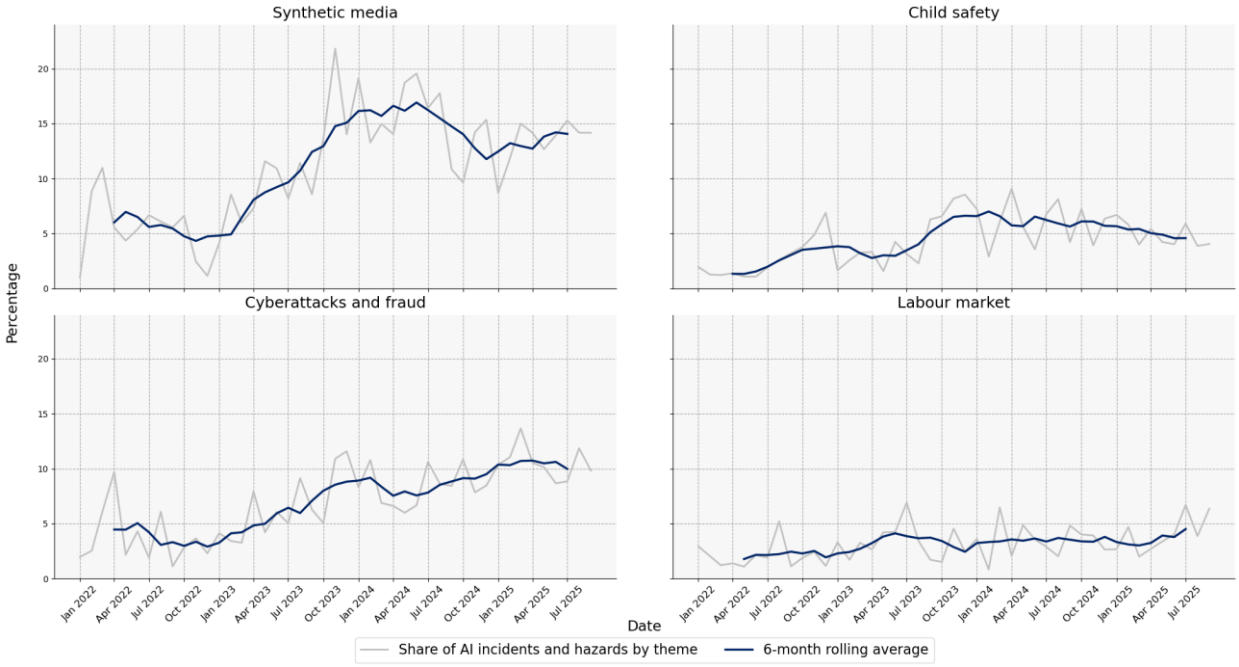
Trends in the share of media coverage of AI-related risks indicate how media attention has shifted over time. These trends do not measure how severe incidents are, the types of harm involved, or the number of affected stakeholders, and should not be read as indicators of these factors. Instead, media coverage should be interpreted in relative terms, by comparing how attention is distributed across the 14 thematic areas. As a reference point, if media attention were evenly distributed, each theme would represent roughly 7% of the total.

3 Increasing coverage

The total number of media-reported AI incidents has increased across most themes over time. However, only four of the fourteen key themes identified in Section 2 – *synthetic media*, *child safety*, *cyber-attacks and fraud,* and *labour market* – have seen a rising share of media attention relative to the total (Figure 3.1). While the share of coverage for these four themes has grown, the rate of growth and the overall volume of reports vary across them.

Figure 3.1. Media-reported AI incidents and hazards showing increasing shares of media coverage include synthetic media and child safety risks, cyberattacks and fraud, and labour market disruptions

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards by theme relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards



Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025.

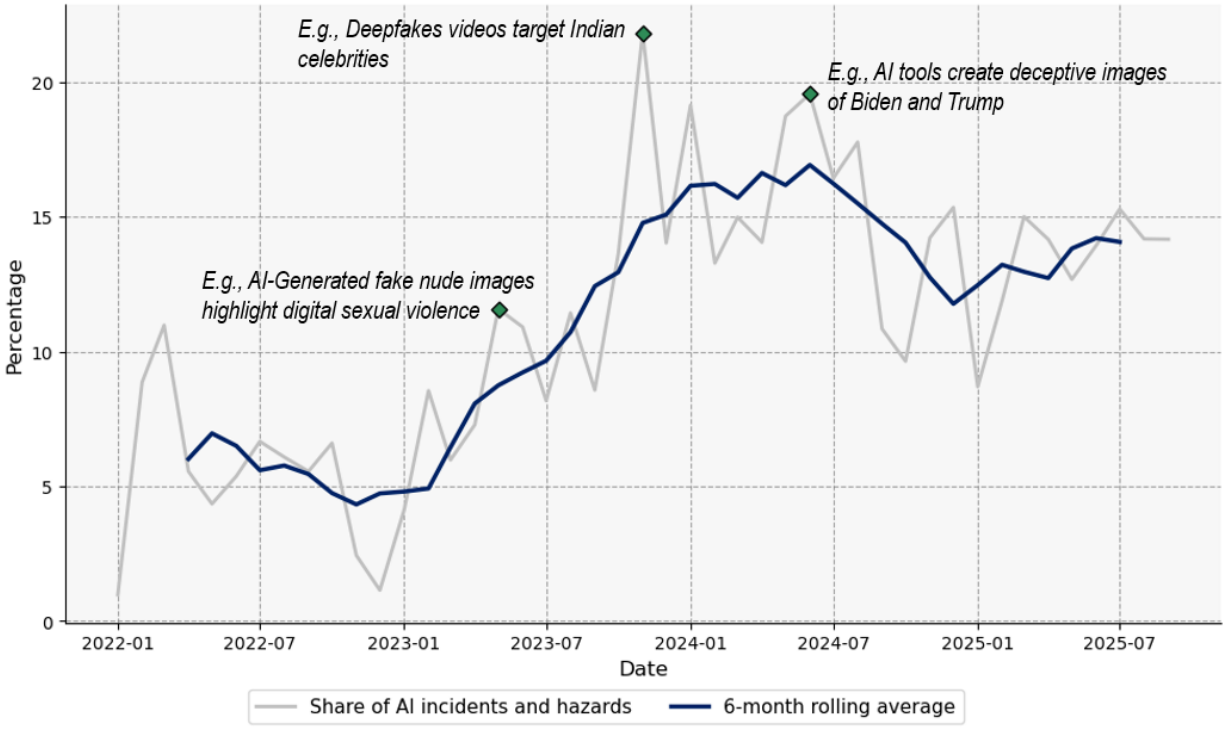
Synthetic media

The share of media-reported AI incidents and hazards related to *synthetic media* grew 2.5 times between 2022 and 2025, representing over 14% the total in the third quarter of 2025. These reports include video, image, and voice generation that may result in false or misleading information. They are sometimes referred to as "deepfakes". Notable peaks happened in May and November 2023 and June 2024 (Figure 3.2).

Notably, the share of this type of reported AI incidents and hazards peaked in November 2023, when it made up 22% of all AIM reports. One notable incident driving this peak is the AI-generated deepfake videos and images of Indian celebrities. This incident was reported by 853 news outlets. Synthetic media risks peaked again in summer 2024, fuelled by deepfake generation in the context of the U.S. presidential election[1].

Figure 3.2. Reports of synthetic media risks have more than doubled since 2022, now accounting for over 14% of all recorded incidents and hazards in AIM

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards related to synthetic media, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in AIM



Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Examples: *AI-Generated fake nude images highlight digital sexual violence*, *Deepfakes videos target Indian celebrities*, and *AI tools create deceptive images of Biden and Trump*.

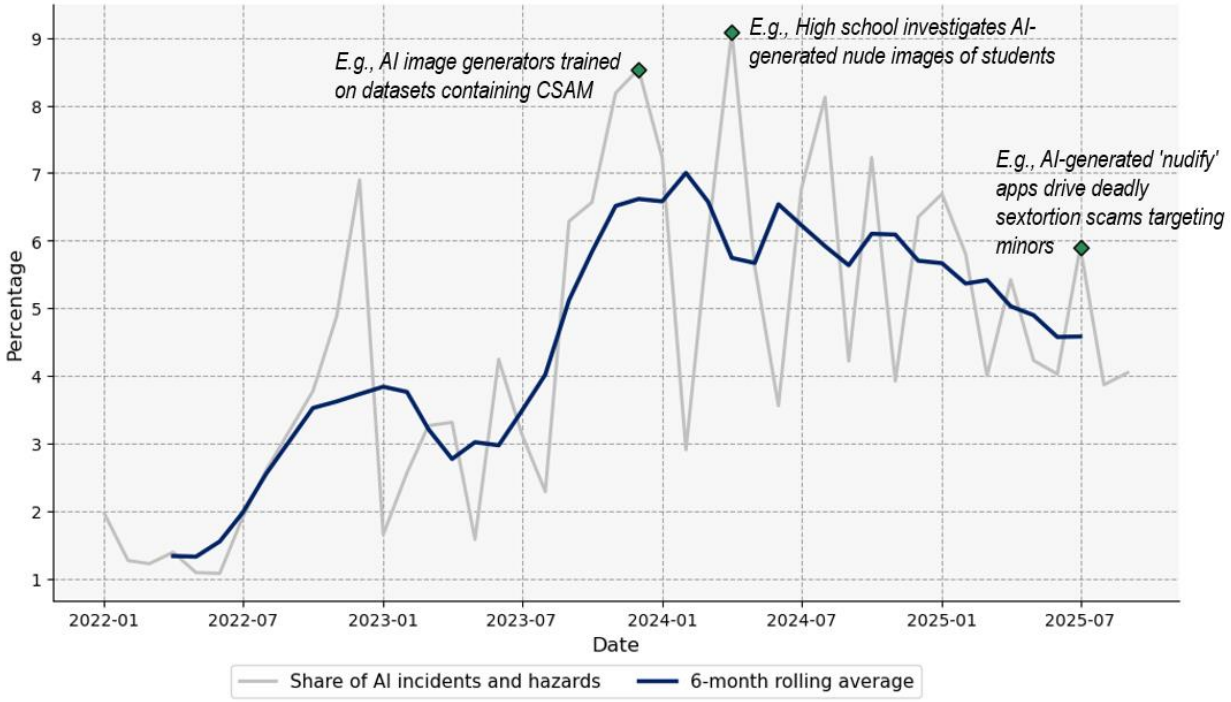
Child safety

The share of media-reported AI incidents and hazards related to child safety doubled between 2022 and 2025 following a peak in late 2023. In April 2024, 9% of all media-reported AI incidents and hazards were related to the topic of child safety (Figure 3.3). Between January 2022 and August 2023, these types of reports represented 2.6% of all reports in AIM. This share increased to 7.7% in the last quarter of 2023 and reached 5.5%, on average, in 2024 until September 2025.

These reports underscore the increase of AI-generated child sexual abuse material (CSAM), at times created by teenagers themselves. These types of issues were reported by the media in countries including Australia, Brazil, Greece, Peru, Singapore and Spain[2]. Child safety also includes recommendation algorithms and targeted ads showing inappropriate content to children and the use of images of real children without consent[3].

Figure 3.3. The share of media reports linked to child safety doubled between 2022 and 2025 but peaked in late 2023 and early 2024

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards related to child safety risks, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in AIM



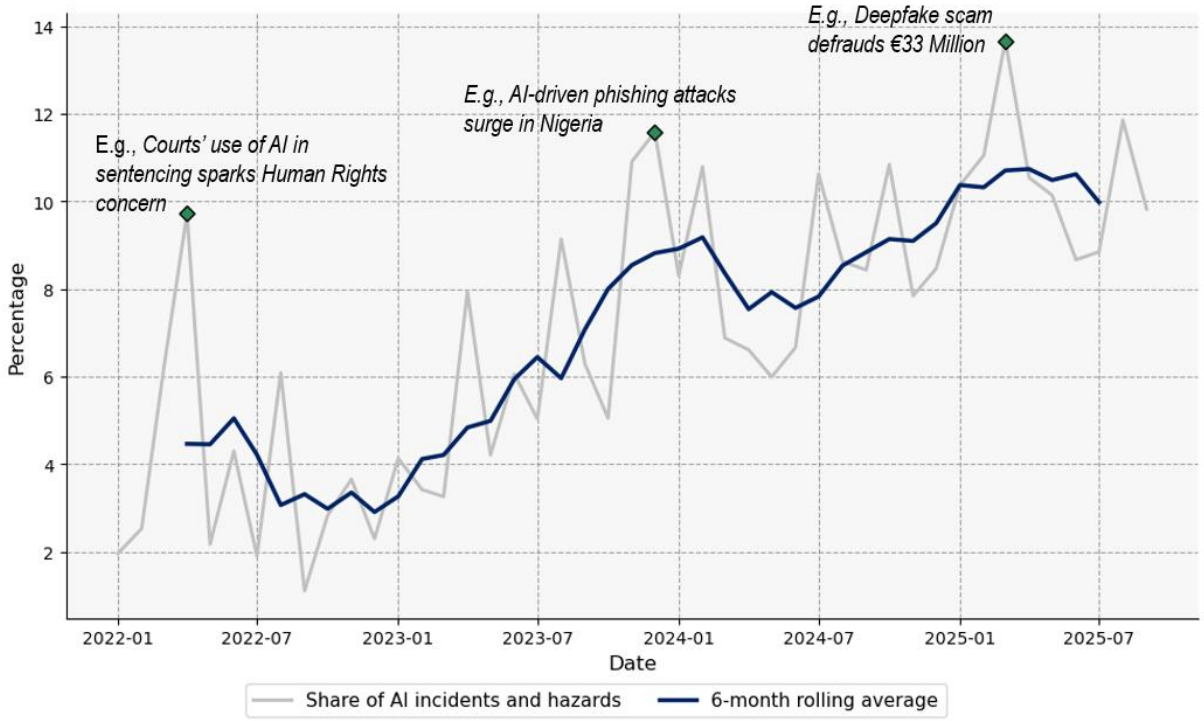
Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annex A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Examples: *AI image generators trained on datasets containing CSAM*, *High school investigates AI-generated nude images of students*, and *AI-generated 'nudify' apps drive deadly sextortion scams targeting minors*.

Cyberattacks and fraud

Media-reported AI incidents and hazards linked to *cyberattacks and fraud* increased by a factor of 2.7 as a share of total reports captured by AIM over the past 3.5 years (Figure 3.4). These reports are linked to the use of AI systems for financial fraud and scams, and phishing attacks[4]. There were notable peaks in April 2022, December 2023 and March 2025. On average, the share of media-reported AI incidents and hazards related to *cyberattacks and fraud* on AIM was of around 3.7% in 2022, growing to almost 10% from September 2024 to September 2025.

Figure 3.4. The share of media reports related to cyberattacks and fraud nearly tripled since 2022

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards related to cyberattacks and fraud, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in the AIM



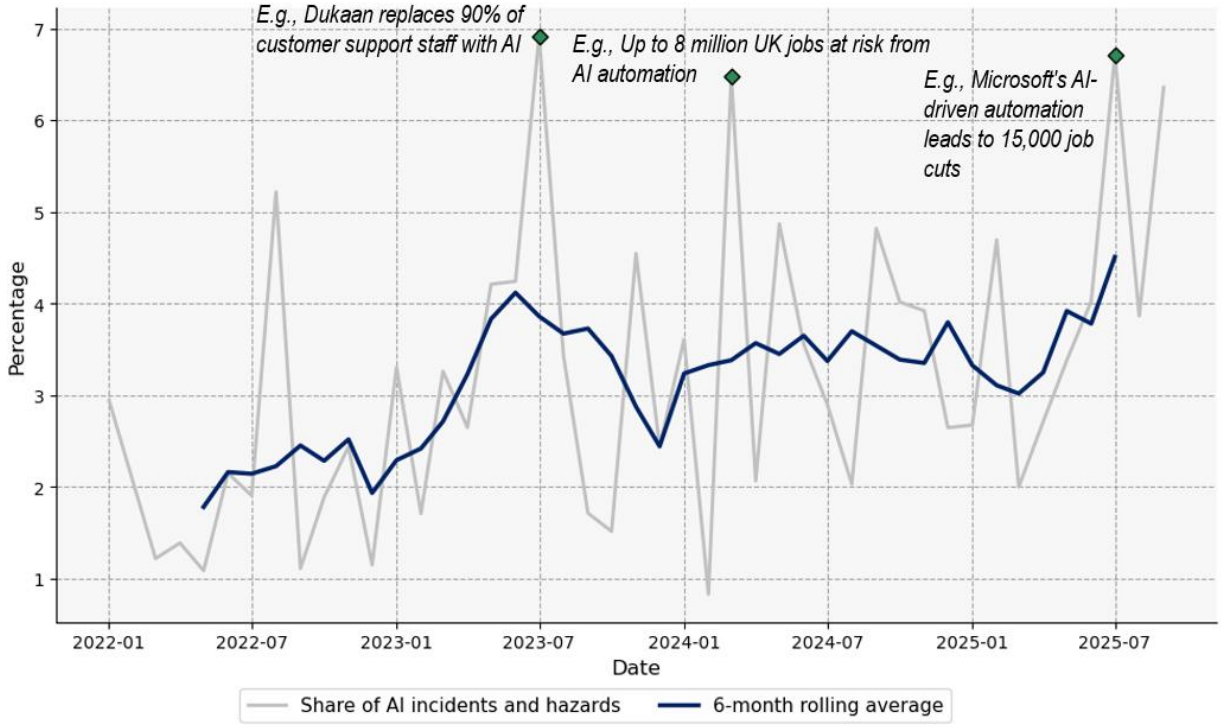
Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Tests did not reveal any seasonality in the data. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Examples: *Courts' use of AI in sentencing sparks Human Rights concern*, *AI-driven phishing attacks surge in Nigeria*, and *Deepfake scam defrauds €33 Million*.

Labour market

Media-reported AI incidents and hazards tied to *labour market* disruptions have been rising steadily, although they represent only a modest share, accounting for about 5.2% of the total in the third quarter of 2025 (Figure 3.5). Reported incidents and hazards in this category are linked to the impact of AI on jobs and the future of work and include lay-offs and AI-driven automation. Notable peaks (at over 6%) linked to this topic took place in July 2023, March 2024, and July 2025.

Figure 3.5. Media-reported labour market disruptions remain a small but growing share of the total

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards related to labour market disruptions, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in AIM



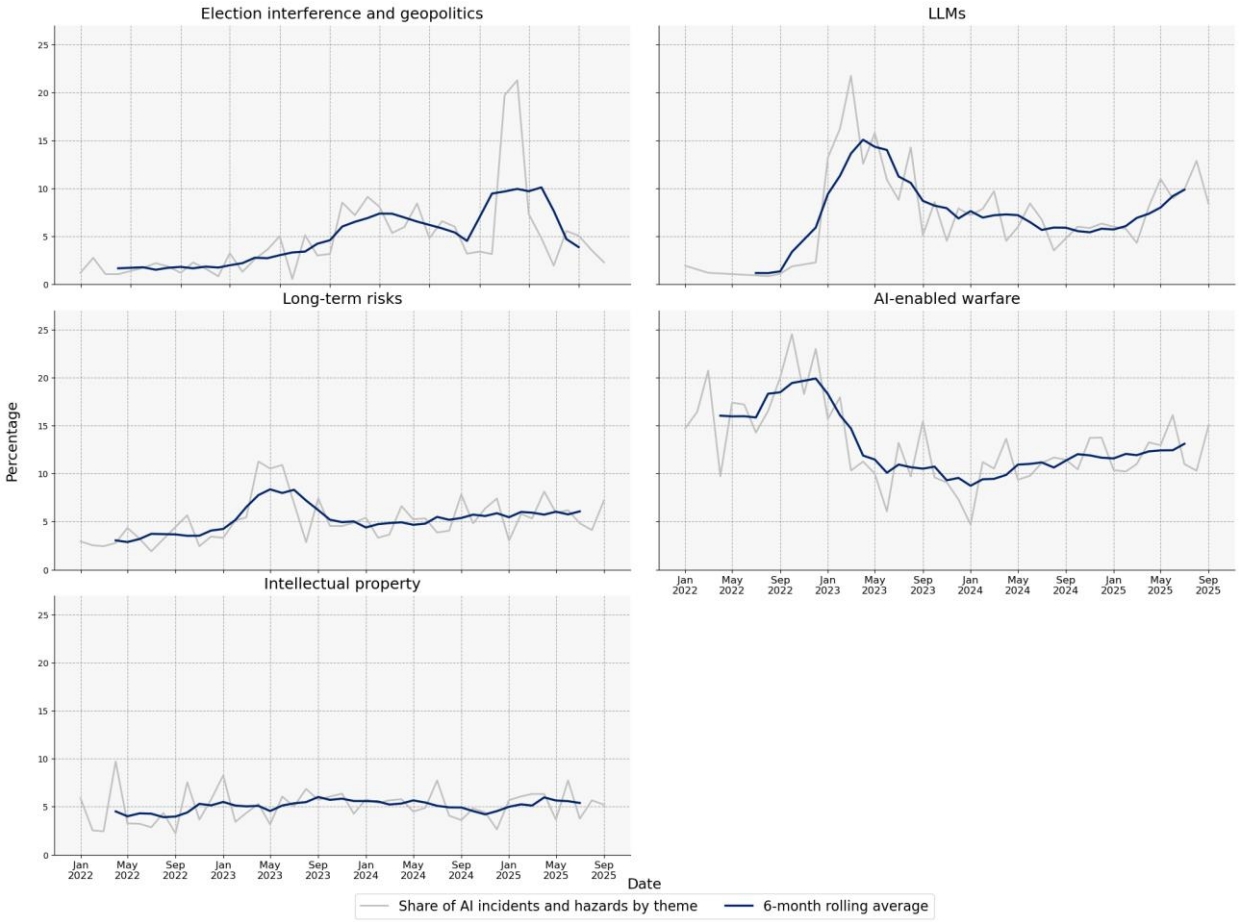
Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Tests did not reveal any seasonality in the data. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Examples: *Dukaan replaces 90% of customer support staff with AI*, *Up to 8 million UK jobs at risk from AI automation*, and *Microsoft's AI-driven automation leads to 15,000 job cuts*.

4 Intermittent coverage

Five themes display intermittent, event-driven coverage over time: *election interference and geopolitics*, *LLM risks*, *long-term risks*, *AI-enabled warfare* and *intellectual property risks*. These themes are marked by sharp, punctual increases – spikes –, or cyclical patterns, in the share of AI incidents and hazards at various points between January 2022 and September 2025 (Figure 4.1). Such spikes likely reflect moments of intensified focus or high-profile events that bring certain risks to the forefront at different times, rather than a steady trend.

Figure 4.1. Intermittent coverage is observed for AI-enabled warfare, LLMs, election interference and geopolitics, intellectual property, and long-term AI risks

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards, by theme



Note: To avoid double-counting, each AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025.

Election interference and geopolitics

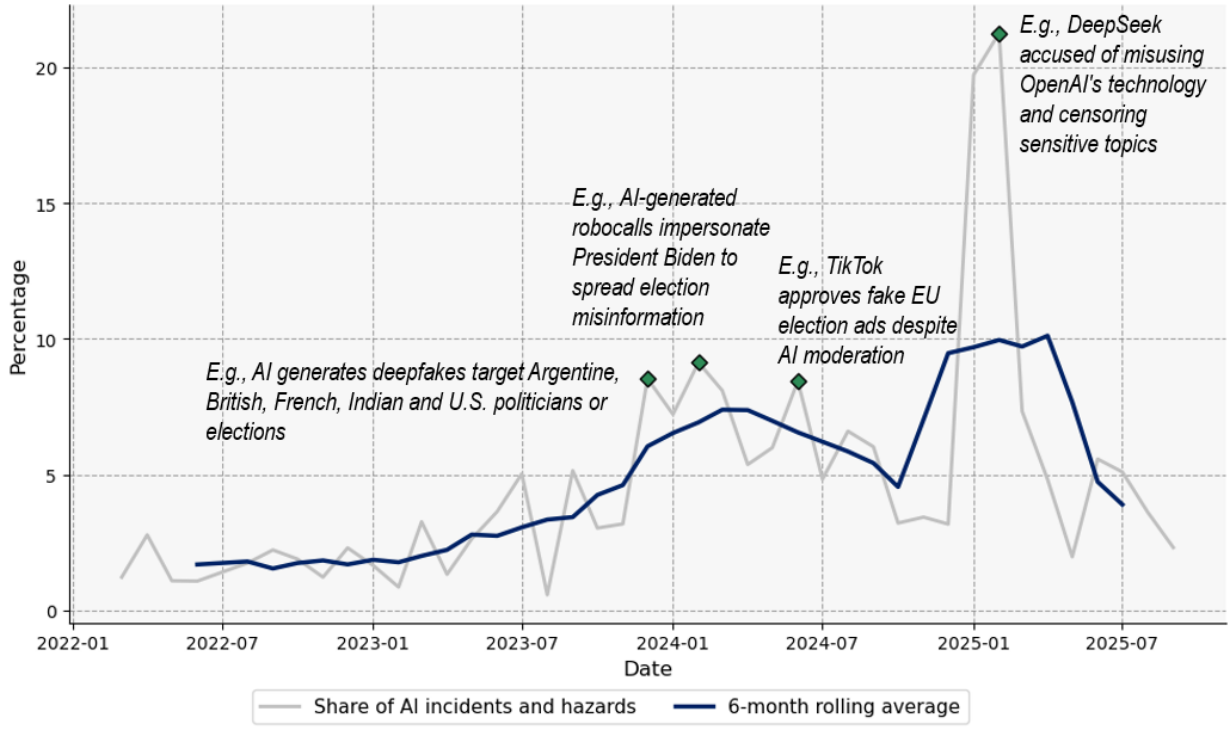
Reports related to *election interference and geopolitics* peaked in February 2025, accounting for over 20% of all media-reported incidents and hazards in AIM (Figure 4.2). This theme captures reports related to AI's influence on democracy, national security, and geopolitical stability. The spike followed a rising trend throughout 2024, a year marked by a high volume of elections globally – including highly-populated jurisdictions such as India, the U.S., Europe, Mexico, Nigeria and Indonesia. In total, more than 3.7 billion people across 72 countries were called to vote in 2024 (UNDP, 2024[8]).

In 2022 and 2023, the share of reports related to *election interference and geopolitics* accounted for 2.6% of reports in AIM. This share nearly doubled to 6% in 2024. In January and February 2025, it almost tripled compared to 2024, peaking at 21% of reported incidents and hazards before decreasing again. The sharp increase in January 2025 is directly linked to the deployment of DeepSeek, widely reported as a major geopolitical event due to its implications for international competition, the governance of open-weight AI models, and the broader dynamics of the global AI landscape.

Reports in this theme include the use of deepfakes to manipulate political campaigns, influence elections, and target politicians around the world.

Figure 4.2. After rising throughout 2024, media reports of incidents and hazards related to election interference and geopolitical issues peaked following DeepSeek deployment in February 2025

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards related to election interference and geopolitical issues, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in AIM



Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Examples: *AI generates deepfakes target Argentine, British, French, Indian and U.S. politicians or elections, AI-generated robocalls impersonate President Biden to spread election misinformation, TikTok approves fake EU election ads despite AI moderation*, and *DeepSeek accused of misusing OpenAI's technology and censoring sensitive topics*.

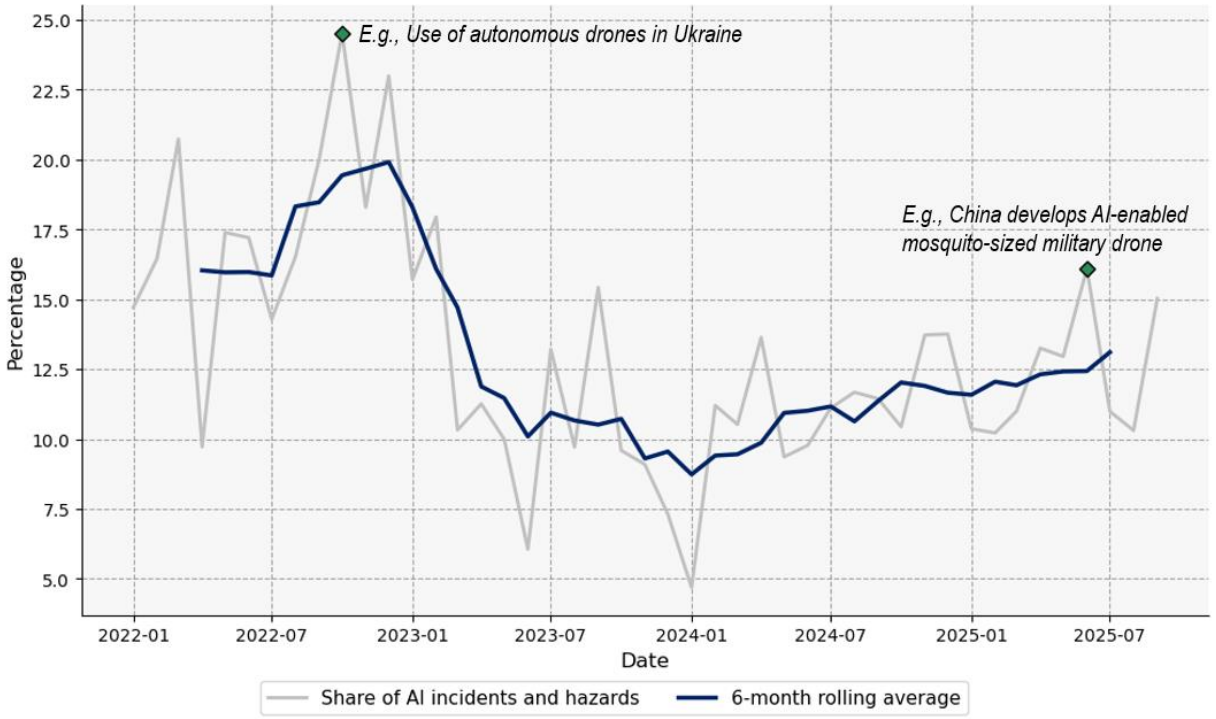
AI-enabled warfare

In the last quarter of 2022, *AI-enabled warfare* incidents and hazards reported by the media made up 22% of the total, mainly fuelled by the Russian Federation's war of aggression against Ukraine. This peak was followed by a decreasing trend until January 2024. Since then, AI-enabled warfare reports have steadily increased.

Reports in this category include military use of AI-enabled tools[5] and autonomous systems, such as drones. From September 2024 to September 2025, they accounted for an average of 12.3% of total reports in AIM (Figure 4.3). While this is a significant drop from late 2022, the share has been steadily increasing again since January 2024.

Figure 4.3. Following a steep decline, reports of warfare-related incidents and hazards are climbing again

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards related to autonomous warfare, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in AIM



Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Examples: *Use of autonomous drones in Ukraine* and *China develops AI-enabled mosquito-sized military drone*.

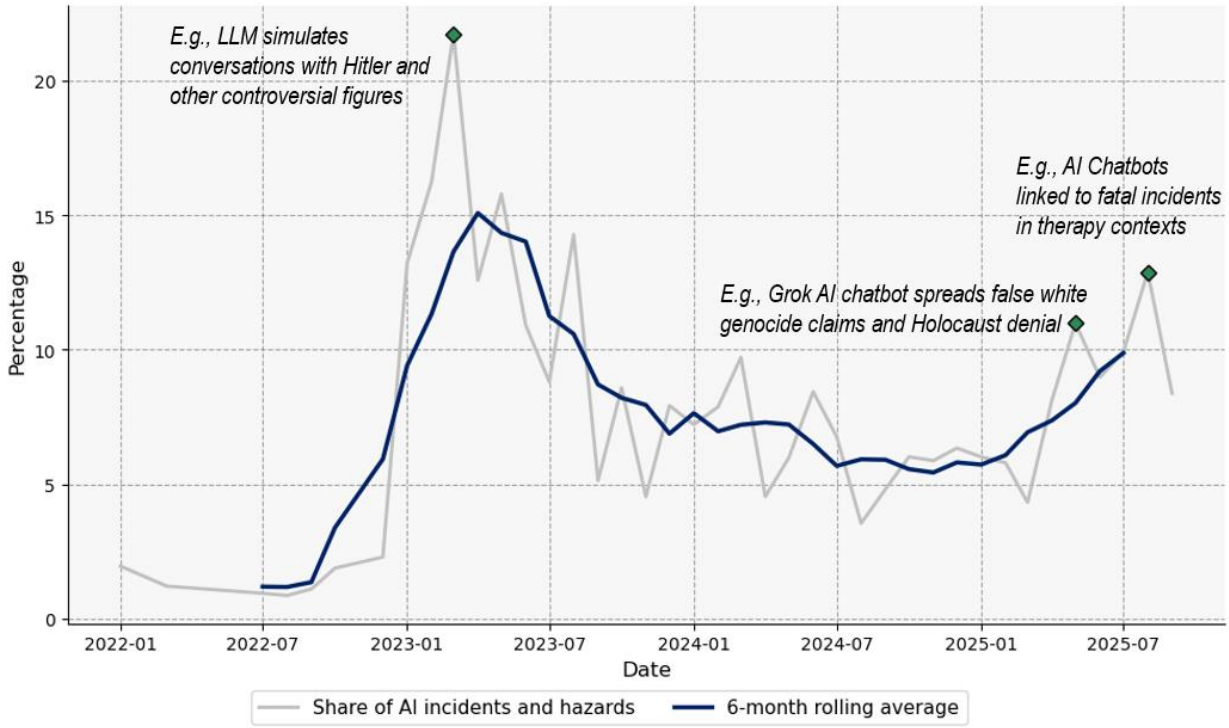
LLMs

The share of media-reported AI incidents and hazards related to *LLM risks* increased by more than eightfold between late 2022 and early 2023 (Figure 4.4). It increased from 2.1% in the last quarter of 2022, to 17% in the first quarter of 2023, reaching close to 22% in March 2023. This theme includes issues related to the development and use of general-purpose AI tools like LLM-powered chatbots and multimodal LLMs (MLLMs).

The spike followed the release of ChatGPT and the rapid deployment of other LLMs in early 2023 (Box 4.1). Common issues included the spread of false or deceptive content, hallucinations, jailbreaking, and broader concerns regarding LLM misuse. While the share dropped to an average of 6.4% in 2024, it rose again to 10.4% in the third quarter of 2025. This increase is related to human-AI interaction risks, particularly cases where LLMs provided harmful or misleading advice that reportedly resulted in severe outcomes, including self-harm or suicide. Some experts have described this emerging risk as a form of AI-induced psychosis.

Figure 4.4. Coverage of media reports related to LLM risks surged eightfold months after ChatGPT's release

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards related to LLMs, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in AIM



Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Examples: *LLM simulates conversations with Hitler and other controversial figures*, *Grok AI chatbot spreads false white genocide claims and Holocaust denial*, and *AI Chatbots linked to fatal incidents in therapy contexts*.

Box 4.1. Notable launches of LLMs and LLM-powered tools in late 2022 and early 2023

- November 2022, OpenAI launched ChatGPT, sparking a global wave of interest and rapid adoption.
- February 2023, Meta released LLaMA (Large Language Model Meta AI), an open-weight LLM with 65 billion parameters.
- February 2023, Microsoft released the AI-powered Microsoft Bing and Edge search, running on OpenAI's LLMs.
- March 2023, Google launched Bard in the United States and the United Kingdom.
- March 2023, OpenAI launched GPT-4 and the Whisper API, including improvements in reasoning mechanisms.
- March 2023, Anthropic launched Claude.

Source: Anthropic, (2023[9]); Brockman et al. (2024[10]); Collins and Hsiao (2023[11]); Mehdi (2023[12]); Meta (2023[13]); OpenAI (2022[14])

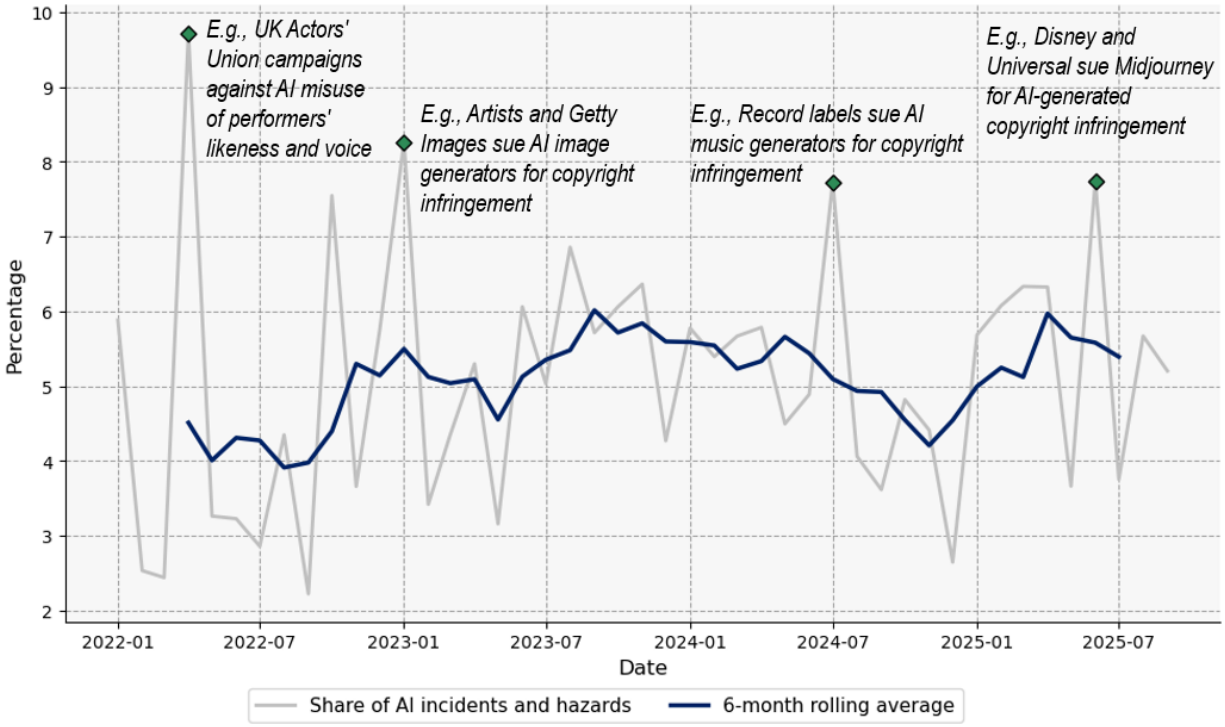
Intellectual property

The share of media-reported AI incidents and hazards related to *intellectual property* has remained relatively stable over time, averaging 5% since 2022 (Figure 4.5). While generally steady, this theme saw several notable peaks: 9.7% of the total in April 2022, 8.3% in January 2023, 7.7% in July 2024 and June 2025.

Most reported incidents involved copyright infringements, such as the alleged unauthorised use of written works like novels and books[6]; videos and images; and likeness and voices for AI training[7]. Other reports included alleged plagiarism and large-scale data scrapping of online platforms[8].

Figure 4.5. Consistent media coverage of intellectual property incidents and hazards, with periodic surges

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards linked to intellectual property risks, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in AIM



Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Examples: *UK Actors' Union campaigns against AI misuse of performers' likeness and voice*, *Artists and Getty Images sue AI image generators for copyright infringement*, *Record labels sue AI music generators for copyright infringement*, and *Disney and Universal sue Midjourney for AI-generated copyright infringement*.

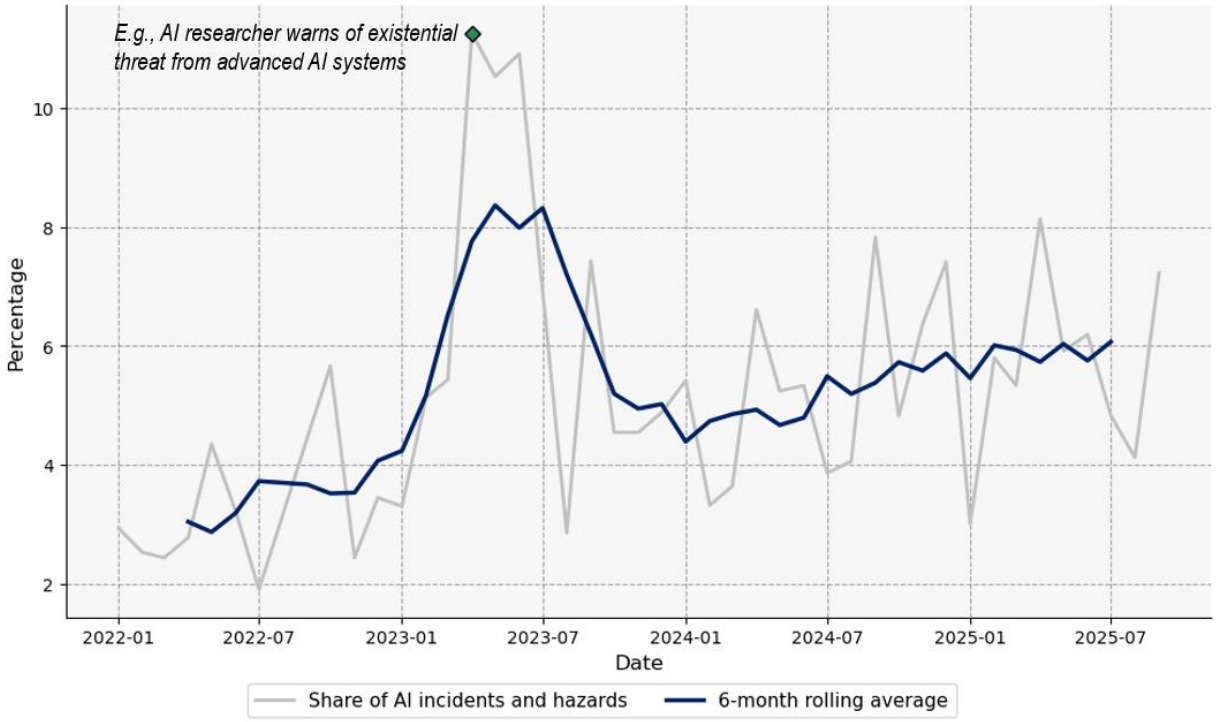
Long-term risks

Media-reported AI incidents and hazards related to *long-term risks* increased sharply – by 260% – between the end of 2022 and beginning of 2023 (Figure 4.6). These risks are largely speculative, focusing on the potential future impacts of AI on society. The spike reflects high-profile warnings about existential risks and calls for stronger regulation (Future of Life Institute, 2023[15]).

Long-term risks accounted for, on average, 3.5% of media-reported incidents and hazards in 2022 and early 2023, rising to almost 9% in the second quarter of 2023 and averaging around 5.6% from July 2024 to September 2025.

Figure 4.6. Spike in long-term risk reports reflects high-profile warnings and calls for regulation

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards linked to long-term risks, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in AIM



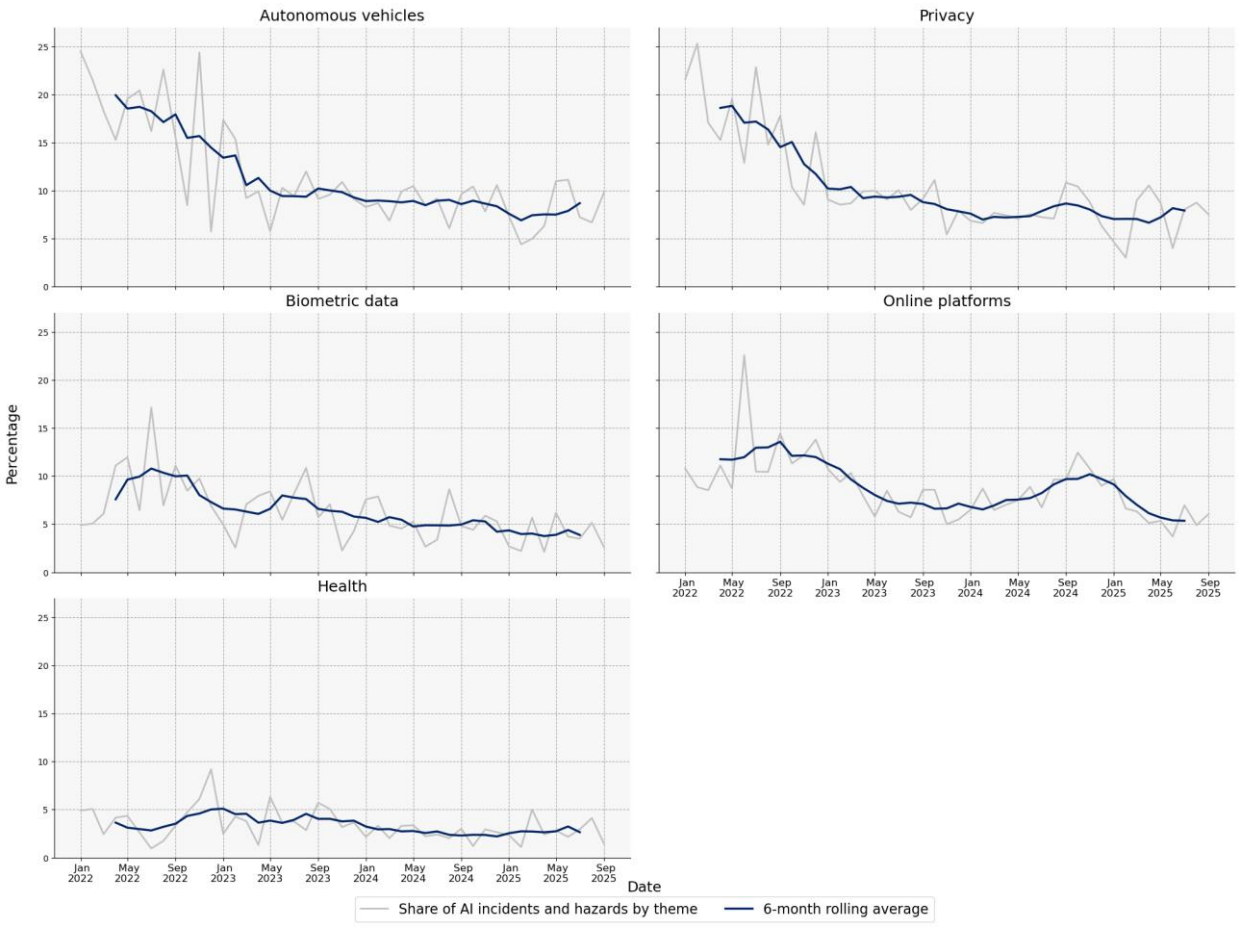
Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Example: *AI researcher warns of existential threat from advanced AI systems*.

5 Decreasing coverage

The share of media coverage has declined for some types of AI incidents and hazards, including those related to *autonomous vehicles*, *biometric data*, *health*, *online platforms* and *privacy violations* (Figure 5.1). This decline reflects a relative drop in media attention and does not imply that these issues are any less important or less of a priority for governance and regulation.

Figure 5.1. Decreasing share of media coverage has been observed for incidents and hazards related to autonomous vehicles, biometric data, health, online platforms, and privacy

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards, by theme



Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025.

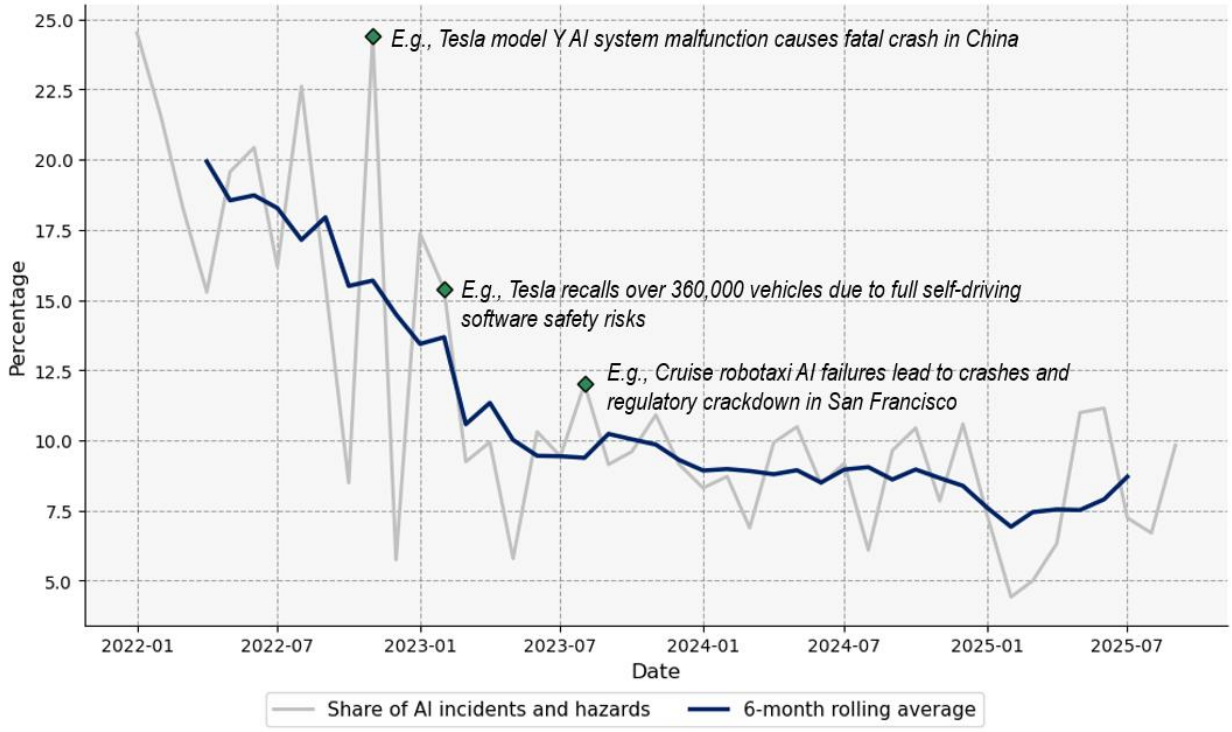
Autonomous vehicles

The share of media-reported AI incidents and hazards related to *autonomous vehicles* dropped by nearly 55% from 2022 through the first three quarters of 2025 (Figure 5.2). These include issues linked to the malfunctioning or unsafe AI features in autonomous vehicles. In 2022, such risks made up 17.7% of all reports in AIM, decreasing to 10.7% in 2023, 8.9% in 2024, and 7.6% in 2025. The highest share was of about 21% in early 2022, and fell to about 5.6% in the first quarter of 2025.

Reports on this theme include vehicle accidents caused by AI malfunctions and security breaches where hackers remotely exploited vehicle software[9]. These reports also shed light on some remediation actions undertaken by companies, including product recalls[10] as well as policy actions such as fines[11].

Figure 5.2. Coverage of incidents and hazards related to autonomous vehicles halved from 2022

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards related to autonomous vehicles, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in AIM



Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Examples: *Tesla model Y AI system malfunction causes fatal crash in China*, *Tesla recalls over 360,000 vehicles due to full self-driving software safety risks*, and *Cruise robotaxi AI failures lead to crashes and regulatory crackdown in San Francisco*.

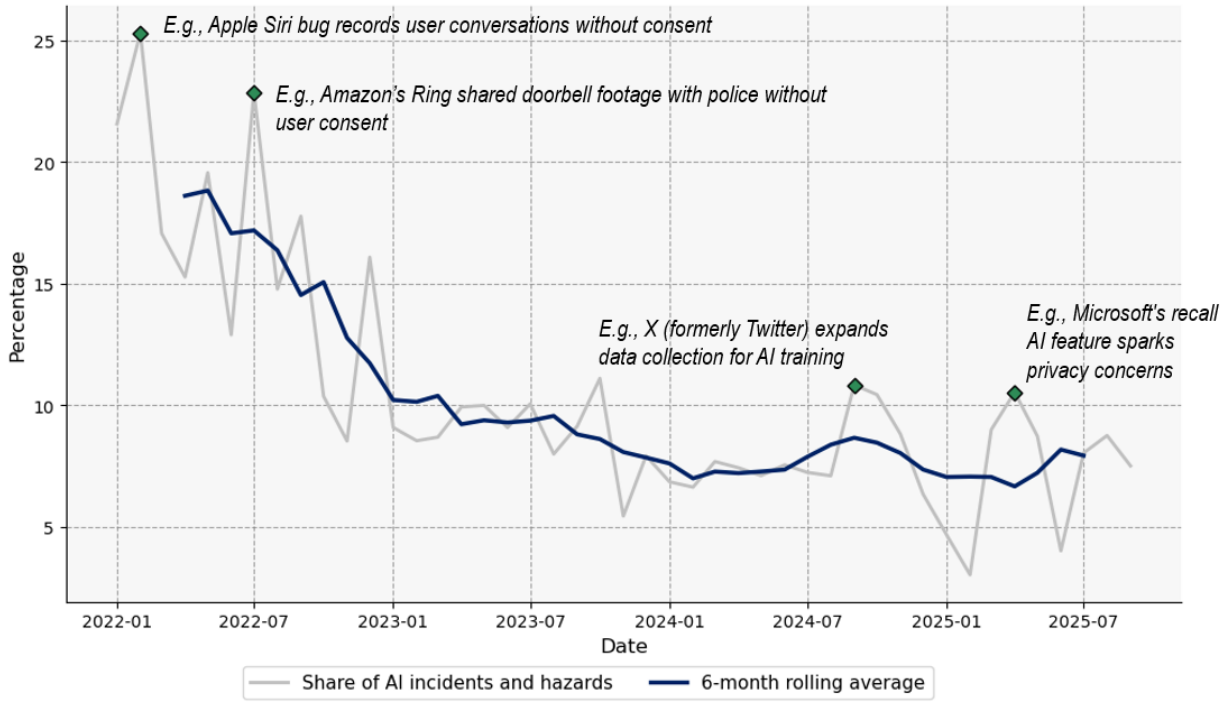
Privacy

Since 2023, around 8% of reports in AIM have involved *privacy* violations (Figure 5.3). These reports include AI-enabled tracking and unauthorised collection or use of personal data. Privacy-related reports peaked at almost 25% (one in four events were linked to privacy) of the total in February 2022 and have decreased steadily since. *Privacy* violations remains the fourth largest theme by count of media-reported AI incidents and hazards and has accounted for 10.4% of total media-reported AI incidents and hazards over time, exceeding the 7% share that would be observed if coverage were evenly distributed across the 14 themes.

Reports in this theme include the use of private communications – such as private messages, emails, and conversations – for AI training by major platforms such as LinkedIn[12], X, Amazon[13], Microsoft and Apple. Other cases involve the analysis of personal data to predict behaviours, including the likelihood of committing a crime[14].

Figure 5.3. Media reports of AI privacy violations dropped sharply in 2022 and have stabilised at around 8%

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards related to privacy violations, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in AIM



Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Examples: *Apple Siri bug records user conversations without consent*, *Amazon's Ring shared doorbell footage with police without user consent*, *X (formerly Twitter) expands data collection for AI training*, and *Microsoft's recall AI feature sparks privacy concerns*.

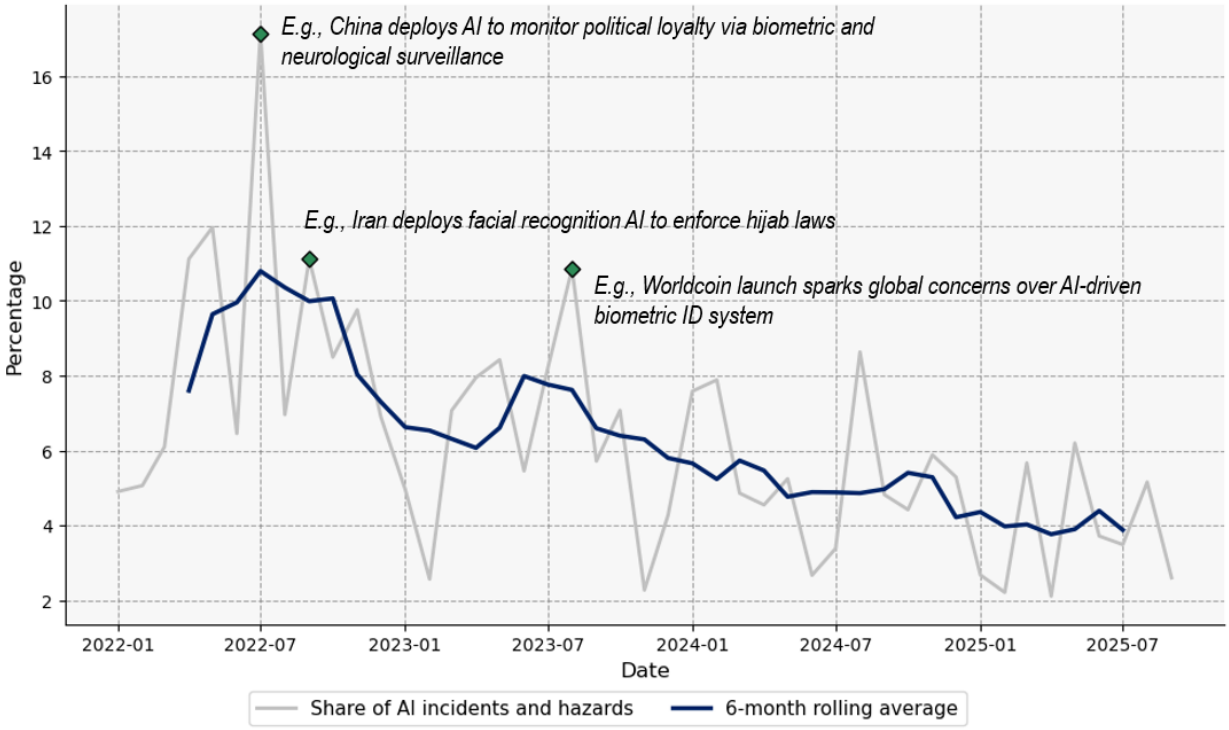
Biometric data

Since 2022, the share of media-reported AI incidents and hazards linked to *biometric data* – such as facial recognition – has more than halved, declining steadily from an average of 8.8% in 2022 – with a peak of 17% in July 2022 – to 6.2% in 2023; 5.4% in 2024; and 3.8% in the first three quarters of 2025 (Figure 5.4). These reports involve the collection, misuse, or leakage of biometric data. While closely related to *privacy violations*, *biometric data* risks are treated as a separate theme given their distinct role in surveillance, identity verification and law enforcement, as well as the uniquely sensitive nature of biometric information.

Reports on this theme illustrate how AI-powered facial recognition systems can be bypassed or malfunction, exposing vulnerabilities in apps, phone security, or door locking systems[15]. Other cases involve biased performance due to physical features like eye shape, skin colour, and cultural symbols or physical attributes like tattoos[16]. This has led in some cases to wrongful arrests or misidentification[17]. Several reports also point to the use of AI-powered surveillance by governments for law-enforcement or immigration control[18].

Figure 5.4. Media coverage of biometric data incidents and hazards has more than halved since 2022

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards related to biometric data, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in AIM



Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Examples: *China deploys AI to monitor political loyalty via biometric and neurological surveillance*, *Iran deploys facial recognition AI to enforce hijab laws*, and *Worldcoin launch sparks global concerns over AI-driven biometric ID system*.

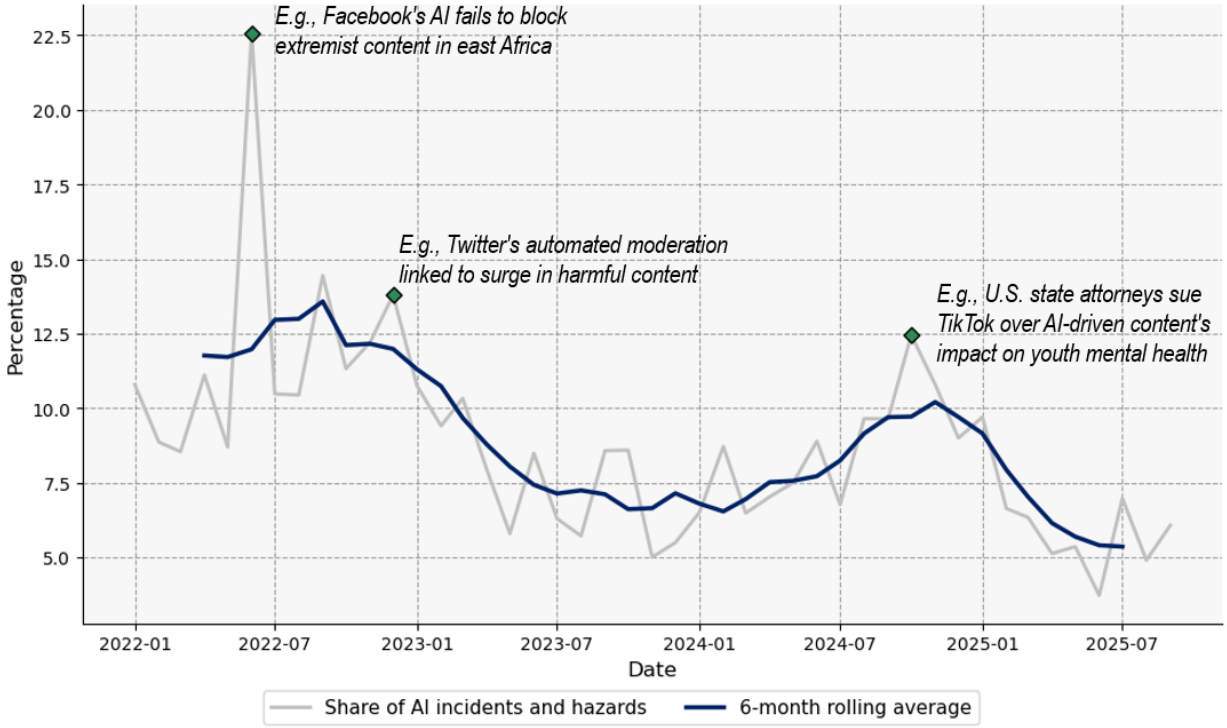
Online platforms

The share of media-reported AI incidents and hazards linked to *online platforms* – such as AI-driven content recommendations and curation – has decreased over time (Figure 5.5). Since January 2025, these reports have averaged 6% of the total, down from almost 12% in 2022.

Such reports involve the recommendation or amplification of harmful or illegal content, including dangerous challenges, banned material and hate speech[19]. In addition, they can increase exposure to extremist, sexist, homophobic, xenophobic, and antisemitic content[20].

Figure 5.5. Media coverage of incidents and hazards related to online platforms has dropped by about 50% since 2022

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards related to platform risks, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in AIM



Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Examples: *Facebook's AI fails to block extremist content in east Africa*, *Twitter's automated moderation linked to surge in harmful content*, and *U.S. state attorneys sue TikTok over AI-driven content's impact on youth mental health*.

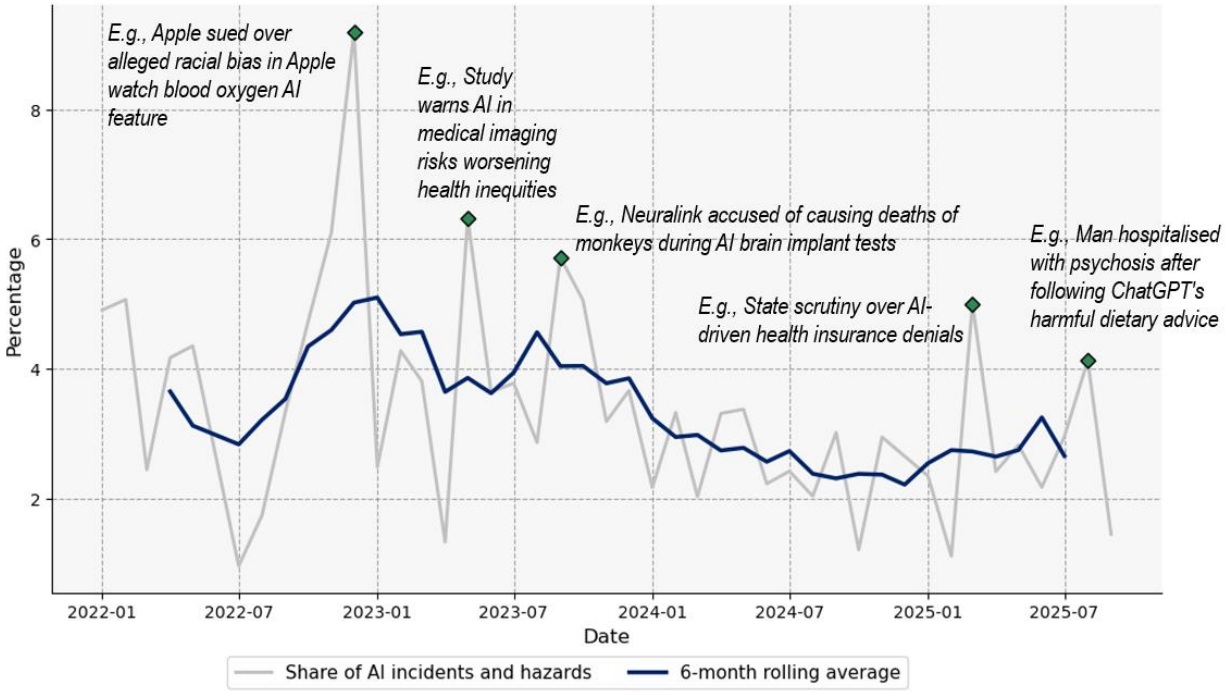
Health

Media-reported AI incidents and hazards related to *health* have decreased from an average of 4.2% of the total in 2022 to 2.7% in the first three quarters of 2025 (Figure 5.6). A peak of 9% was observed in December 2022. These reports involve AI-related physical and mental health risks and harms.

Reports in this theme include AI biases in medical tools like tumor recognition systems and overall patient care; risks in mental health apps[21]; and AI-driven decision-making in health insurance[22]. Some reports also involve emerging AI technologies, such as brain control devices using AI chips.

Figure 5.6. Media coverage of health AI incidents and hazards has decreased to about 3% of the total

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards related to health risks, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in AIM



Note: To avoid double-counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard was assigned to the most relevant theme. Please see the methodological note and Annexes A and B for more information.

Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Examples: *Apple sued over alleged racial bias in Apple watch blood oxygen AI feature*, *Study warns AI in medical imaging risks worsening health inequities*, *Neuralink accused of causing deaths of monkeys during AI brain implant tests*, *State scrutiny over AI-driven health insurance denials* and *Man hospitalised with psychosis after following ChatGPT's harmful dietary advice*.

6 Conclusion and next steps

The OECD.AI Incidents and Hazards Monitor (AIM) offers a unique, real-time view window into how media attention to different AI-related risks is evolving. By tracking media reports of AI incidents and hazards across multiple domains, AIM reveals where attention to AI risks and harms is rising, uneven, or declining. Analysis of this data can help surface trends and insights into nature and impact of issues associated with AI technologies. The classification of media reports into 14 thematic clusters offers a structured framework for this analysis.

While media attention varies by theme and over time, AIM underscores the need for continuous monitoring to detect and understand emerging incidents and hazards as they occur. Peaks in reporting often coincide with high-profile events or major technological developments, while declining attention may conceal persistent or underreported risks.

As AI adoption expands globally, AIM serves as a key resource for tracking trends in media coverage of AI risks and harms and their potential impacts on society. Although AIM currently relies on media-reported data, it plays a crucial role in building an evidence base to better understand, prevent, and respond to AI-related risks and harms.

Next steps could include allowing open submissions to complement media-based monitoring and reorganising incidents and hazards visually by theme to support deeper analysis. Integrating additional datasets – such as case law, global recall portals, or academic research – could provide a more complete view of AI incidents and hazards, helping policymakers identify systemic risks, cascading effects, and potential prevention and response mechanisms.

Annex A. Methodological note

The OECD.AI Incidents and Hazards Monitor (AIM) detects AI-related risks and harms from reputable news outlets in real-time and many languages. A machine learning exercise was conducted to identify key trends in AIM data from January 2022 to September 2025.

Identifying key thematic clusters

LLM-generated summaries of AI incidents and hazards were collected and transformed into a semantic representation capturing the underlying concepts. Using a *k*-means clustering algorithm, these reports were classified into 25 thematic clusters each capturing semantically similar risk characteristics. For each cluster, the most relevant keywords were identified to better understand underlying themes and reduce apparent overlaps. This resulted in 14 distinct themes.

Other topic-modelling algorithms – including the Latent Dirichlet allocation (LDA), latent semantic analysis (LSA) with singular value decomposition (SVD) – were tested (Cao et al., 2009[16]; Foltz, 1996[17]). These algorithms resulted in thematic clusters driven by geographical themes (locations and notable stakeholders) or to specific companies and platforms. Since the objective of the analysis is to identify global trends in AI incidents and hazards across thematic risk categories, these algorithms were not retained.

To ensure analytical clarity and prevent double counting, each event was assigned to a single thematic cluster based on its dominant topic. See Annex B for more information.

Sentence embedding

To identify the themes of AI incidents and hazards, event summaries were analysed using natural language processing. The authors applied Hugging Face's sentence-transformer model, all-MiniLM-L6-v2, which converts each summary into a numerical vector capturing contextual and semantic relationships in the text (Hugging Face, 2025[18]). These vectors were then used for clustering.

Clustering AI incidents and hazards

After embedding, the *k*-means clustering algorithm – an unsupervised machine learning algorithm – was used to group similar reports without prior labels.

The authors tested different numbers of clusters (10, 15, 20, 25 and 30) using the elbow method and silhouette scores (Januzaj, Beqiri and Luma, 2023[19]; Shi et al., 2021[20]). Since these methods gave inconsistent results, the authors chose 25 clusters based on a qualitative keywords review. For each cluster, the term frequency-inverse document frequency (TF-IDF) method identified the most relevant keywords (Qaiser and Ali, 2018[21]). English stop-words (e.g., "the", "a", "is") were removed to improve the performance of the model. These keywords helped interpret and label themes.

Manual validation for cluster coherence

An internal review of the 25 clusters – using keyword analysis, event counts, and random manual checks of selected media reports – led to their consolidation into 14 distinct themes.

A second clustering exercise was conducted to confirm the classification of all events under the 14 consolidated themes and to ensure that events from merged clusters were correctly reassigned. This was followed by a second round of manual validation (Table A.1) to confirm the appropriateness of the final thematic assignments.

Table A.1. Top keywords by theme

Keywords associated with each of the 14 consolidated thematic clusters

Theme name	Top keywords per theme
Synthetic media	Deepfake, generated, videos, public, voice, misinformation, fake, media, social
AI-enabled warfare	Autonomous, military, drones, harm, systems, future, risks, enabled, potential, defense, powered
Cyberattacks and fraud	Financial, fraud, scams, using, phishing, security, attacks, driven, generated
Online platforms	Content, TikTok, Meta, harm, users, moderation, recommendation, media, misinformation
Privacy	Privacy, surveillance, rights, violations, potential, human, enabled, harm, risks
Biometric data	Privacy, facial, recognition, rights, violations, biometric, human, potential, surveillance
Autonomous vehicles	Tesla, safety, autonomous, driving, vehicles, risks, incidents, vehicle, self, systems
LLMs	ChatGPT, chatbots, OpenAI, users, chatbot, harm, including, privacy, content, potential
Election interference and geopolitics	Chinese, DeepSeek, security, election, generated, misinformation, privacy, deepfakes, government
Labour market	Jobs, significant, driven, automation, workers, roles, warn, labor, risk
Child safety	Images, deepfake, content, generated, used, create, harm, child, privacy, sexual, nude
Health	Health, brain, risks, harm, human, patient, medical, concerns, Neuralink, researchers
Intellectual property	Legal, rights, lawsuit, property, intellectual, copyrighted, alleging, content, train
Long-term risks	Risks, potential, human, systems, harm, future, including, security, concerns, warned, development

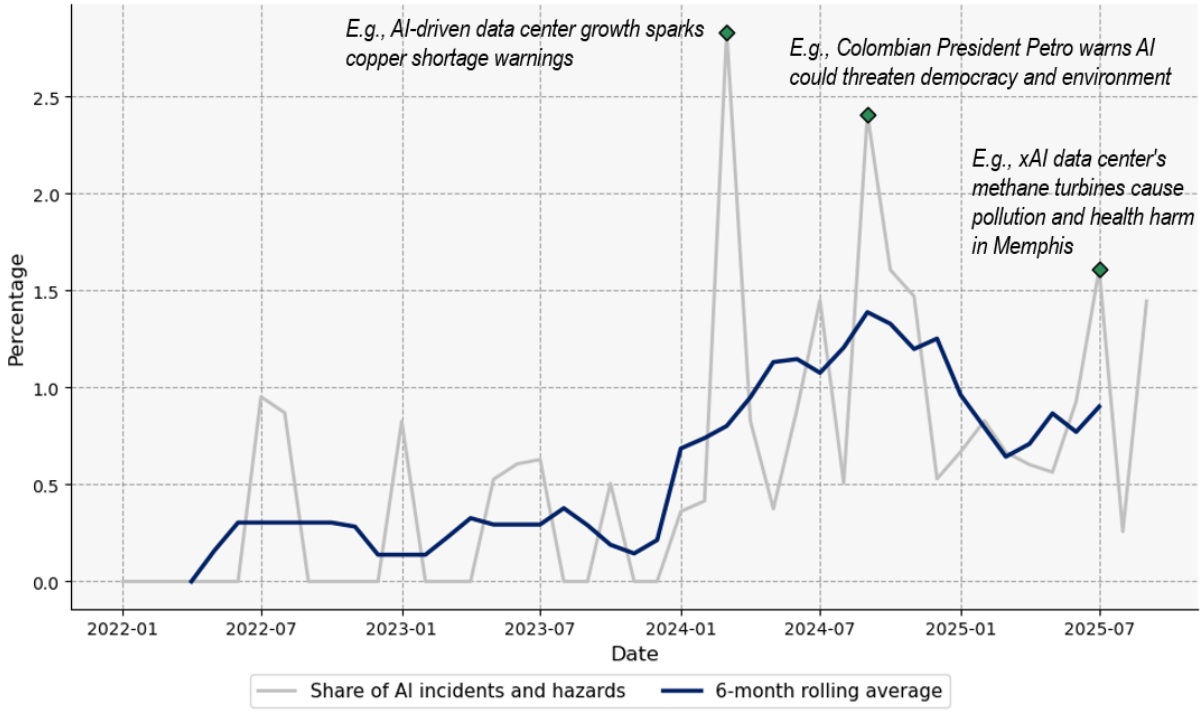
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025.

Manual validation showed that media-reported AI incidents and hazards linked to *environmental* risks – such as high demand for energy, water, and raw materials – were included within other themes. For example, reports on emissions from AI-driven data centres were classified under themes such as *health, labour market,* and *long-term* related risks. These events did not form a separate theme in the *k*-means analysis due to their relatively low frequency in the dataset.

A separate manual review was conducted to identify and analyse *environmental* risk patterns in media coverage, which are presented in Figure A.1. On average, these reports accounted for 0.6% of the total. As AI technologies continue to evolve, associated risks may also change, and new themes – such as *environmental* risks – may emerge over time.

Figure A.1. On average, media-reported AI incidents and hazards linked to environmental risks represented 0.6% of all reports

Proportion of AI incidents and hazards related to environmental risks, relative to all media-reported AI incidents and hazards captured in AIM



Note: The events depicted in this graph are included in one of the 14 clusters described in the main text, given their relatively low frequency. Consequently, these values should not be interpreted in comparison to the 14 clustered described in this paper.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025. Examples: *AI-driven data center growth sparks copper shortage warnings*, *Colombian President Petro warns AI could threaten democracy and environment*, and *xAI data center's methane turbines cause pollution and health harm in Memphis*.

Additional tests

Measuring seasonality

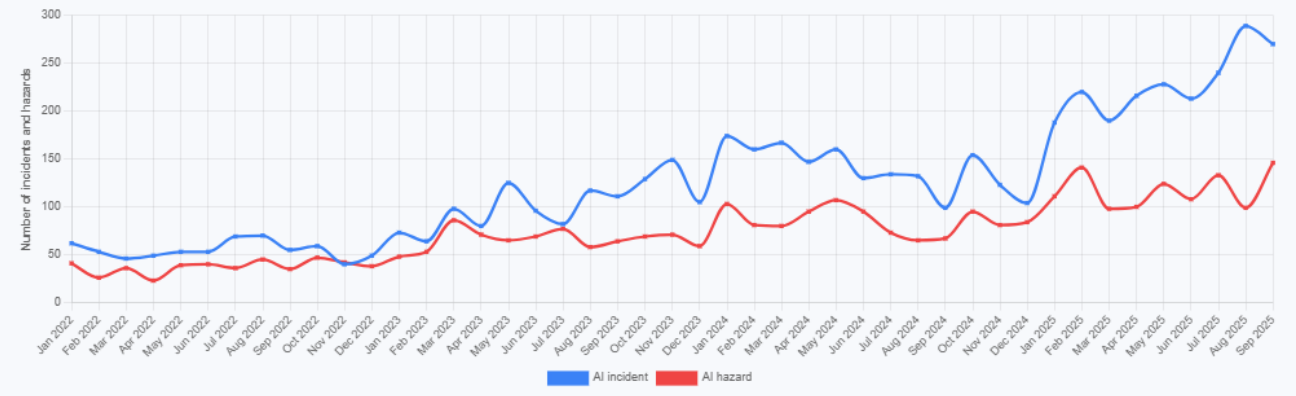
To better understand trends, the authors tested for seasonality using autocorrelation functions (ACF) over 12- and 24-month periods (Bell, Ghysels and Lee, 1997[22]). Results showed no statistically significant seasonal patterns for any of the themes.

Correlation between media-reported AI incidents and hazards

Correlation testing shows a strong positive relationship (0.90) between the monthly counts of media-reported AI incidents and hazards. This suggests that underlying events and media attention follow similar patterns over time for both, as illustrated in Figure A.2. This finding does not support the view that isolated incidents drive short-term spikes in media reporting of hazards.

Figure A.2. Media reporting of AI incidents and hazards is highly correlated

Evolution of media-reported AI incidents and hazards



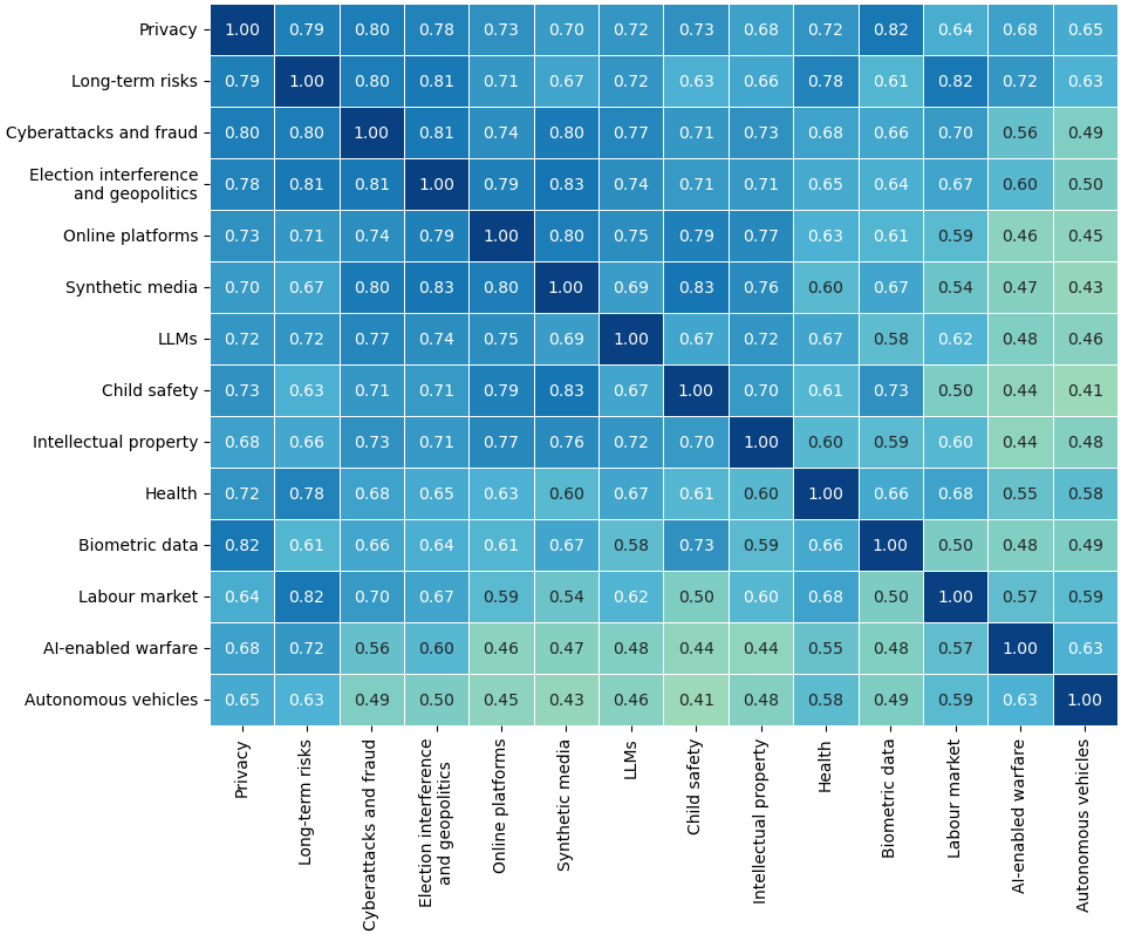
Note: An AI incident or hazard can be reported by one or more news articles covering the same event. Please see the methodological note for more information.
Source: OECD.AI (2025[5])

Annex B. Similarity between themes

To ensure analytical clarity and avoid double counting, each media-reported AI incident or hazard is assigned to a single theme based on the most relevant available information. While this approach supports coherence and comparability across themes, some reports may be relevant to more than one theme.

To capture these overlaps, an additional analysis examined the relatedness between themes. For each theme, a centroid embedding was calculated from the embeddings of its associated media reports and compared using cosine similarity (Morissette and Chartier, 2013[23]). The resulting similarity matrix shows how closely related the themes are to one another, with higher values indicating greater semantic similarity (Figure B.1).

Figure B.1. Semantic similarity matrix of the 14 themes



Note: The values and colour gradient denote the degree of semantic similarity between pairs of clusters. A value of 1 indicates perfect alignment, meaning the clusters are semantically identical. A value of 0 indicates no meaningful relationship between clusters. Higher values indicate greater semantic relatedness. Values are rounded to two decimal places.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025.

Some themes show higher semantic overlap with others (Table B.1). The *privacy* theme, for example, has an average semantic similarity score of 0.73, indicating that privacy-related AI incidents and hazards are often closely linked to other themes. In particular, reports on *cyberattacks and fraud* and *biometric data* show strong links to *privacy* risks, with similarity scores of 0.80 and 0.82, respectively. This highlights that, while each report is assigned to a primary theme, multiple themes often co-occur in media reporting.

Conversely, themes such as *autonomous vehicles* and *AI-enabled warfare* show less overlap with other themes, reflected in lower average similarity scores of 0.52 and 0.55, respectively.

Table B.1. Average similarity score per theme

Theme name	Average semantic similarity score
Privacy	0.73
Long-term risks	0.72
Cyberattacks and fraud	0.71
Election interference and geopolitics	0.71
Online platforms	0.68
Synthetic media	0.68
LLMs	0.66
Child safety	0.65
Intellectual property	0.65
Health	0.65
Biometric data	0.62
Labour market	0.62
AI-enabled warfare	0.55
Autonomous vehicles	0.52

Note: The average similarity score shows the average cosine similarity between all themes, excluding self-similarity. This indicates how semantically close a theme is to all the other ones. Values are rounded to two decimal places.
Source: OECD analysis using data from AIM, https://oecd.ai/incidents, from January 2022 to September 2025.

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